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IMPLEMENTATION COMPLETION AND RESULTS REPORT

TF0A4737

ON A

SMALL GRANT

FROM THE JAPAN SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT FUND

IN THE AMOUNT OF US\$2.75 MILLION

TO THE

REPUBLIC OF SIERRA LEONE

FOR

STRENGTHENING COMMUNITY MOBILIZATION AND LOCAL COUNCIL SERVICE
DELIVERY IN THE POST-EBOLA CONTEXT (P155339)

JUNE 27, 2021

Social Protection and Jobs Global Practice
Africa West Region

(Exchange Rate Effective June 14, 2021)

Currency Unit = Sierra Leone Leones (Le)

SLL 10,425.35 = US\$1

SDR 0.69638368 = US\$1

FISCAL YEAR

January 1 - December 31

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ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS

A4P	Agenda for Prosperity
BA	Beneficiary Assessment
CAS	Country Assistance Strategy
CDC	Center for Disease Control
CLoGPAS	Comprehensive Local Government Performance Assessment System
CMG	Community Monitoring Group
CMI	Community Monitoring Intervention
CMU	Country Management Unit
CPF	Country Partnership Framework
CSOs	Civil Society Organizations
DecSec	Decentralization Secretariat
DSDP	Decentralized Services Delivery Program
EERP	Ebola Emergency Response Plan
ESMF	Environmental and Social Management Framework
EVD	Ebola Virus Disease
FCDO	The Foreign Commonwealth Development Office
FDD	Fiscal Decentralization Department
FM	Financial Management
GDP	Gross Domestic Product
GoSL	Government of Sierra Leone
GRM	Grievance Redress Mechanism
IDA	International Development Association
IE	Impact Evaluation
IEC	Information, Education and Communication
INPSS	Integrated National Public Service Survey
J-CAS	Joint Country Assessment Strategy
JICA	Japan International Cooperation Agency
JSDF	Japan Social Development Fund Project
LC	Local Council
LCSA	Local Council Social Accountability
LGA	Local Government Act
MDA	Ministries, Departments, and Agencies
MoSWGCA	Ministry of Social Welfare, Gender, and Children's Affairs
M&E	Monitoring and Evaluation
NSAP	National Social Action Program
PP	Project Paper
PB	Participatory Budgeting
PDO	Project Development Objectives
PERS	Post-Ebola Recovery Strategy

PFMU	Projects Fiduciary Management Unit
RTF	Resident Technical Facilitator
SCD	Systematic Country Diagnostic
SLNMTDP	Sierra Leone National Medium-Term Development Plan (2019-2023)
TPM	Third-Party Monitoring
WDC	Ward Development Committees
WHO	World Health Organization

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DATA SHEET

BASIC INFORMATION

Product Information

Project ID	Project Name
P155339	Strengthening Community Mobilization and Local Council Service Delivery in the Post-Ebola Context
Country	Financing Instrument
Sierra Leone	Investment Project Financing
Original EA Category	Revised EA Category
Partial Assessment (B)	Partial Assessment (B)

Organizations

Borrower	Implementing Agency
Republic of Sierra Leone	Decentralization Secretariat, Project Fiduciary Management Unit, Local Government Finance Department

Project Development Objective (PDO)

Original PDO

The Project Development Objective is to respond to the post-Ebola Virus Disease (EVD) needs at the local level in Sierra Leone by building community resilience through EVD sensitization efforts and social mobilization activities in the districts most affected by the disease.

FINANCING

	Original Amount (US\$)	Revised Amount (US\$)	Actual Disbursed (US\$)
Donor Financing			
TF-A4737	2,750,000	2,746,253	2,746,253
Total	2,750,000	2,746,253	2,746,253
Total Project Cost	2,750,000	2,746,253	2,746,253

KEY DATES

Approval	Effectiveness	Original Closing	Actual Closing
06-Feb-2017	23-Jun-2017	27-Dec-2020	27-Dec-2020

RESTRUCTURING AND/OR ADDITIONAL FINANCING

Date(s)	Amount Disbursed (US\$M)	Key Revisions
28-Jan-2020	1.78	Change in Implementing Agency Change in Components and Cost Reallocation between Disbursement Categories Change in Institutional Arrangements

KEY RATINGS

Outcome	Bank Performance	M&E Quality
Highly Satisfactory	Satisfactory	Substantial

RATINGS OF PROJECT PERFORMANCE IN ISRs

No.	Date ISR Archived	DO Rating	IP Rating	Actual Disbursements (US\$M)
01	08-Dec-2017	Satisfactory	Satisfactory	0.00
02	28-Jun-2018	Moderately Satisfactory	Moderately Satisfactory	0.67
03	26-Jan-2019	Moderately Satisfactory	Moderately Satisfactory	0.67

04	10-Sep-2019	Moderately Satisfactory	Moderately Satisfactory	1.78
05	23-Apr-2020	Moderately Satisfactory	Moderately Satisfactory	1.78
06	24-Dec-2020	Satisfactory	Moderately Satisfactory	2.75

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I. PROJECT CONTEXT AND DEVELOPMENT OBJECTIVES

A. CONTEXT

1. **During appraisal of the Japan Social Development Fund (JSDF) project**, the total population of Sierra Leone was approximately 7.5 million, with nearly 50 percent 0-18 years old.¹ The poverty headcount ratio was 56.8 percent, with a concentration of 73.9 percent in rural areas.² The country's gross domestic product (GDP) averaged 3.8 percent annual growth in 2017, with an overall per capita GDP of US\$498.³
2. **The Ebola epidemic reversed the country's post-civil war macroeconomic stability and strained government capacity to deliver services.** There was a 50-60 percent disruption in agriculture, manufacturing, and private-sector employment, including a suspension of five new ventures valued at approx. US\$1.2 billion. Transport and cross-border trade came to a standstill. GDP fell more than 21 percent, inflation hit double digits, and the currency depreciated more than 50 percent.⁴ The education system closed, and schools were converted to treatment centers, as the health system collapsed with 23 percent fewer beneficiary services. Water and sanitation projects were disrupted, experts fled the country, and public works were generally put on hold.
3. **The Ebola epidemic spurred mistrust among neighbors, of official health information, and of formal institutions, disrupting social cohesion and stability.** Literature reviews of lessons learned from HIV/AIDS in Sub-Saharan Africa highlight that education and interpersonal relationships are prime factors in overcoming stigma. Rapid sampling during the outbreak indicated that nearly a third of Ebola Virus Disease (EVD) survivors exhibited a mild mental disorder and nearly a third of survivors were stigmatized by their communities.⁵
4. **The government of Sierra Leone (GoSL) is strongly committed to supporting EVD survivors, relatives of the deceased, and their communities.** The GoSL effectively stemmed the immediate spread of EVD,⁶ and with World Bank support, launched the Ebola Emergency Response Plan (EERP) to improve public health systems and economically revive communities. In addition, the ministries, departments, and agencies provided EVD psycho-social services: the Ministry of Social Welfare, Gender, and Children's Affairs (MoSWGCA) mobilized resources with UNICEF and civil society organizations (CSO) to support children and families; and the Ministry of Health and Sanitation devolved staff to PHUs to better deliver psychological services.⁷ In 2015, GoSL established the National Association of Ebola Survivors (NAES) as a community-based organization to map, locate, and sensitize EVD survivors and to advocate for their wellbeing. At the community level, the devolution of government over the previous decade meant Local Councils (LCs) were well-positioned to reach the poor and vulnerable and to help rebuild societal wellbeing.

1 <https://data.worldbank.org/country/sierra-leone>

2 <https://data.worldbank.org/country/sierra-leone>; <https://www.imf.org/~media/Files/Publications/CR/2020/English/1SLEEA2020001.ashx>

3 <https://www.imf.org/~media/Files/Publications/CR/2020/English/1SLEEA2020001.ashx>

4 Staff's report for the third and fourth Reviews under Sierra Leone's previous Extended Credit Facility Arrangement elaborates on the macroeconomic impact of the twin shocks (IMF Country Report No. 15/323, November 2015).

5 The Kessler scale is based on a ten-item questionnaire that yields a global measure of distress based on questions about anxiety and depressive symptoms that a person has experienced in the most recent four-week period.

6 In 2007, junior and senior secondary Gender Parity Indices based on GERs were 0.78 and 0.52 respectively, by 2010/11 they were 0.80 and 0.59.

7 Each District has an average of 50 PHUs, under the MoHS. PHUs plan, organize, and monitor health provision, train staff, work with communities, and supply equipment and drugs. PHUs are the delivery point for primary health care (a functional area devolved to LCs). There are three types of PHUs: Community Health Centers, Community Health Posts, and Maternal and Child Health Posts.

B. SECTORAL AND INSTITUTIONAL CONTEXT

5. **The donor community mobilized resources to halt the spread of EVD. International CSOs and NGOs provided care and tracked infected individuals.** The most active of these were the: International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies, International Medical Corps, International Rescue Committee, Doctors without Borders, Plan International, and Save the Children. The most visible UN agencies included: UNICEF, UN Development Program, UN High Commissioner for Refugees, UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs, and World Food Program (WFP). Most carried out sensitization campaigns.

6. **The JSDF project was designed to complement the above support and reestablish social cohesion, inclusion and trust** by sensitizing communities on the causes of the disease—myth-busting—and by creating mechanisms for social deliberation and social accountability— mobilizing citizens by means of collective action mechanisms, such as citizen-centric monitoring and citizen feedback mechanisms and putting in place the first innovative public participatory budgeting measures in two pilot districts (Freetown City Council (FCC) and Port Loko). The participatory budgeting pilot was designed to reflect community demand-driven services bringing services closer to the citizens. In 2017, the psycho-social impact of the disease on communities, for lack of surveys, was not well understood, but anecdotal information indicated a lack of trust in the government.

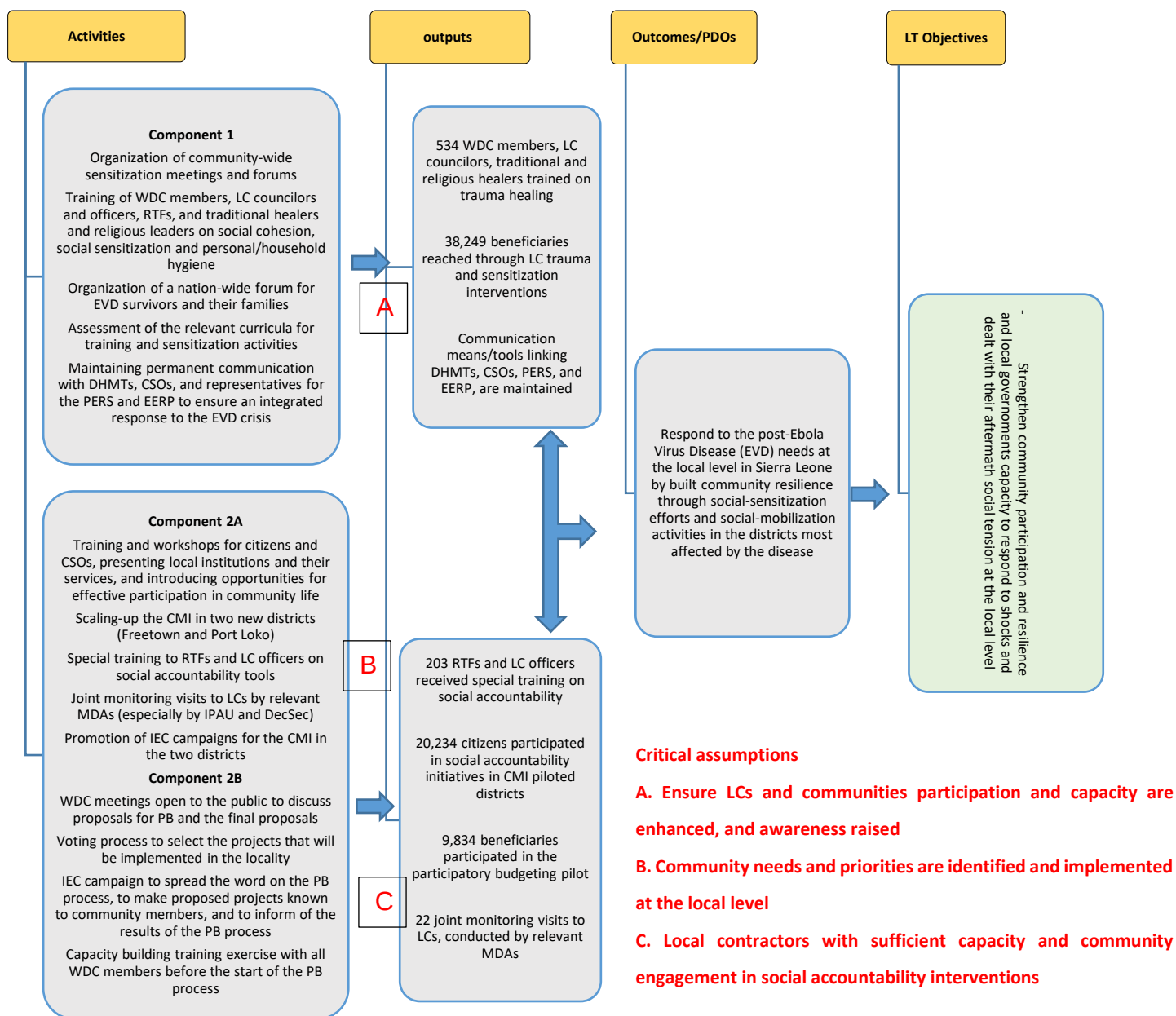
7. **Engaging local leadership was a key element to rebuilding social cohesion.** Engaging local leaders was factored into project design given the country's historically complex State-society relation, marked by years of political instability, and the fragility of the civil war period. The project focused on engaging the two key local authorities who play important roles in Sierra Leone: Chiefdoms and LCs by ensuring buy-in by both democratically elected leaders (LC councilors and Ward Development Committees (WDC) members) and traditional authorities (community and paramount chiefs).

8. **The project built on the Decentralized Service Delivery Program (DSDP2, P119355) (former Service Delivery Bank operation closed in June 2018) implementation structures which included the Project Management Fiduciary Unit (PFMU) formerly known as the Integrated Project Administrative Unit (IPAU) and the Decentralized Secretariat (DecSec).** These are two key institutions who have been at the forefront of the GoSL's decentralization and service delivery engagement in Sierra Leone, along with the Fiscal Decentralization Department (FDD), formerly known as the Local Government Finance Department (LGFD). DecSec is a department of the Ministry of Local Government and Rural Development (MLGRD) and one of DSDP2's implementing agencies. It is the GoSL department in charge of the decentralization process, providing capacity building and backstopping support to LCs, coordinating nationwide strategic discussions on devolution, and monitoring local level service delivery. DecSec staff include one Resident Technical Facilitator (RTF) in each LC as DecSec's focal point. RTFs provide feedback and report on local-level challenges/capacity gaps to DecSec for prompt intervention. The PFMU, in the Ministry of Finance and Economic Development (MoFED), is the second implementing agency of DSDP2 and acts as a supervising entity at the project level. The MoFED was the project fund recipient. It supports capacity building to strengthen fiduciary management, intergovernmental coordination, monitoring, administration, supervision, and auditing. The PFMU includes staff and expertise in the areas mentioned. Lastly, FDD, allocated in MoFED, provides monitoring and mentoring support to LCs on financial matters and is in charge of central government funding of LCs.

Theory of Change (Results Chain)

9. **For this Implementation Completion and Results Report, the project's Theory of Change is constructed ex-post as a formal Theory of Change was not a requirement during preparation.** Nevertheless, the project implicitly followed the principles of the Theory of Change. During project preparation, the government and Bank teams identified critical activities that would: (i) strengthen decentralized service delivery through a community demand-driven safety net approach and partnership with local government and provide a framework for an inclusive and transparent budgetary process supporting investments targeted at reducing vulnerability and improving access to basic service delivery and bringing services closer to end beneficiaries. This, in turn, supported establishing a complementary safety net intervention for end beneficiaries and providing them with a minimum level of well-being; (ii) create a platform for communities to address and resolve stigma and discrimination and strengthen social cohesion and improve trust in local government, which was absent at the time of project design and appraisal; and (iii) support investments targeted at reducing vulnerability by increasing access to improved quality of basic services. Consequently, the project's Results Framework (RF) articulated the project's path from planned interventions to intended outcomes. The Theory of Change is retrofitted from the RF, as presented in the original Project Paper (Figure 1).

Figure 1: Theory of Change



C. PROJECT DEVELOPMENT OBJECTIVES (PDOS)

10. **Under the Project Paper and the Grant Agreement, the objective of the project was to respond to the post-EVD needs at the local level in Sierra Leone by building community resilience through social-sensitization efforts and social-mobilization activities in the districts most affected by the disease.** While the post Ebola needs go beyond the scope of what the project could deliver, the project scope and design were prepared in line with the JSDF guidelines⁸ to support priority areas and gaps identified in consultation with the Client and to complement other ongoing interventions. The project was designed to support two priority post Ebola needs (sub-objectives), namely, enhancing social harmonization/inclusion (social sensitization) and improving access to service delivery and making government accountable and transparent (social accountability). The two sub-objectives were designed to support the achievement of the PDO and to allow for a more targeted RF.

11. The PDO and the RF were not revised during implementation.

D. COMPONENTS

- The JSDF project had three components Component 1 – LC social-sensitization activities – sought to promote social cohesion and resilience by strengthening LC capacity and by implementing community-wide sensitization meetings, forums, and health talks in the Bombali, FCC /Western Area Urban, Port Loko, and Western Area Rural Districts, together representing 70 percent of all EVD cases in Sierra Leone, to diminish the negative effects of EBV on social trust and to provide much-needed support to the victims.
- Component 2 – Creating social-mobilization mechanisms to improve LC service delivery – focused on building community resilience in FCC/Western Area Urban and Port Loko Districts by: (i) creating social-accountability and community-monitoring mechanisms for the effective delivery of social services; (ii) promoting direct citizen engagement in the monitoring of LC services; and (iii) piloting participatory budgeting.
- Component 3 - Project management, M&E, and knowledge management – focused on operations support for project management, procurement, financial management, and monitoring and evaluation.

12. **Project Location:** Social sensitization activities under Component 1 were undertaken in the four (4) districts most affected by EVD judging by the total number of EVD laboratory-confirmed cases (these are Western Area Urban District / FCC LC, Port Loko District, Western Area Rural District, and Bombali District), which represented close to 70 percent of all EVD cases in the country. A community monitoring intervention (CMI) and participatory budgeting were piloted in the two districts most affected by EVD, according to the total number of EVD laboratory-confirmed cases (these are Western Urban District / Freetown LC and Port Loko District).

E. KEY EXPECTED OUTCOMES AND OUTCOME INDICATORS

13. At appraisal, the key outcome indicators for the project were:

- Percentage of beneficiaries who affirm social sensitization activities have been positive toward bringing people together in the four (4) districts in which social sensitization activities are conducted.⁹

⁸ The JSDF had guidelines for priority activities they can finance. For example, income generating activities (e.g., productive inclusion) were considered post Ebola need, however, it was not permissible to finance according to the JSDF guidelines.

⁹ As measured by an additional question to be included in DSDP2's Integrated National Public Services Survey (INPSS). INPSS is an annual survey that assesses

- Number of sectors in CMI piloting districts quarterly assessed and managed considering citizen feedback.¹⁰
- Percentage of beneficiaries who affirm participatory budgeting processes generated a positive social mobilization effect in the two (2) districts in which participatory budgeting is conducted.¹¹
- Direct project beneficiaries - estimated to reach 50,000 direct beneficiaries, of which 50 percent women¹²

F. SIGNIFICANT CHANGES DURING IMPLEMENTATION (IF APPLICABLE)

14. Despite progress made under component 1 and sub-component 2A, implementation had been slower than expected under sub-component 2B. By November 30, 2019, the Bank had advanced to the GoSL US\$1.78 million (64.7 percent of the total project allocation), of which the GoSL disbursed US\$1.35 million (49.1 percent of total allocation). This was significantly lower than the expected disbursement estimates during the Mid-Term Review (May 28-June 11, 2019), which was US\$2.15 million (78.2 percent of total allocation).

15. A number of exogenous factors and administrative changes, listed below, slowed down implementation

- a) The Sierra Leone Presidential election held in March/ April 2018 resulted in a change of government, with the new government pursuing a different agenda and seeking to restructure functions and staff from line ministries, including the Ministry of Local Government, where DecSec sits.
- b) Parallel to the Presidential election, the people of Sierra Leone voted for new local representatives. The leadership of 3/4 LCs tasked with implementing the project changed as well as key staff. This required orientation and training of new staff.
- c) The new Minister of Local Government and Rural Development terminated the contracts of six out of nine staff at DecSec, including the Director of the Unit and key specialists, between the second and third quarters of 2018. A new team was subsequently hired and 12 employees joined DecSec during the first quarter of 2019.

16. In order to resolve the implementation delays, an agreement was reached in June 2019 to undertake a Level 2 Restructuring to address: (a) slow disbursements; (b) depleted operational costs affecting the frequency of project supervision by the implementing agencies; and (c) the need to strengthen the institutional arrangements on the fiscal side for sub-component 2B. Though not explicitly stated in the Restructuring paper, the Bank team worked with the GoSL to address the gap created by the departure of key staff at DecSec due to the administrative changes resulting from the April 2018 elections and the subsequent change in LCs leadership, both which drained the institutional memory and momentum¹³ of project implementation.

17. The restructuring addressed (a, b, and c) outlined above. Jointly the Bank team and implementing agencies developed a revised disbursement plan, put in place a request for the reallocation of resources (see Table 1 below), and further clarified the institutional arrangements (adding the Local Government Finance Department, the name changed to the Fiscal Decentralization Division (FDD)) to accelerate the implementation of sub-component 2B (Participatory

beneficiary perception of local public services and local institutions.

¹⁰ As measured by a new variable to be included in DSDP2's Comprehensive Local Government Performance Assessment System (CLOGPAS). CLOGPAS is an annual survey that monitors capacity developments at the LC level, assesses LC performances on a comparative basis, and identifies capacity needs.

¹¹ As measured by an additional question to be included in INPSS.

¹² Figures are calculated drawing from the estimated number of beneficiaries of other Decentralized Delivery Service Project Phase 2 activities which reflected a similar scope. The JSDF project was piloted in a limited number of LCs. The number of participants in the participatory budgeting pilot was estimated to be equivalent to the minimum participation threshold required under Component 2: at least 2,500 participants per LC.

Budgeting). The addition of FDD was a critical step in complementing DecSec technical capacity in budgeting and intergovernmental fiscal management.

Table 1. Reallocation by expenditure category

Expenditure category	Current allocation	Reallocation amount	Total with reallocation	% change
(1) Consultant services	US\$ 118,500	-US\$10,000	US\$ 108,500	-8.44%
(2) Training and workshops	US\$ 776,500	-	US\$ 776,500	-
(3) Goods	US\$ 581,000	-US\$ 50,000	US\$ 531,000	-8.61%
(4) Subgrants	US\$ 1,220,000	-	US\$ 1,220,000	-
(5) Operating costs	US\$ 54,000	US\$ 60,000	US\$ 114,000	+111.11%

Source: table designed by Bank team (data from PFMU and Bank Project FM Specialist).

II. OUTCOME

A. RELEVANCE OF PDOs

Assessment of Relevance of PDOs and Rating

18. **The project sub-objectives remain relevant to Sierra Leone's development priorities.** The project continues to be relevant to the development priorities of Sierra Leone and consistent with the 2021-2026 Country Partnership Framework (CPF, Report No. 148025-SL), which focuses on strengthening community engagement and social inclusion, maximizing the impact of service delivery, and building confidence in institutions under Focus Area 1. Sustainable Growth and Accountable Governance; these three key objectives were addressed by the project activities. The project is aligned with the CPF key outcomes for human capital acceleration by ensuring decentralized service delivery, leveraging additional resources, and anchoring sound public finance management. Components 2 (A and B) were designed to reflect and respond to these sub-objectives.

19. **The project also aligned with the 2012-2022 Africa Region Social Protection Strategy,** which supports "increasing access to and improving the quality of basic services, protecting households, and guaranteeing a minimum level of wellbeing by reducing their vulnerability. The project also supported the larger work of the Africa Emergency EVD Response Program.

20. **Rating.** The scope, PDO, and objectives of the project remained the same and relevant to project design, during implementation, and at the time of project closing. There were no shortcomings in the relevance of the operation to the Bank's Sierra Leone CPF, Country Assistance Strategy (CAS), Systematic Country Diagnostic (SCD), African Region Social Protection Strategy, or Africa Region Emergency EVD Response Program. Country circumstances changed, particularly due to the COVID-19 Pandemic, but did not impact the higher-level outcomes. The project design included a mechanism to allow for a shock responsive approach which was reflected in the project's response during the COVID-19 pandemic in the pilot districts. The project is rated **High** in Relevance to the PDO.

B. ACHIEVEMENT OF PDOs (EFFICACY)

Rating: *High*

Assessment of Achievement of Each Objective

21. **The project responded to the post-EVD needs at the local level (PDO) through two sub-objectives.** As stated under the PDO section, the PDO was defined by two sub-objectives after consultation with the Client and in line with the JSDF financing guidelines. Key PDO sub-objectives were: (a) enhancing social harmonization/inclusion (social sensitization); and (b) improving access to service delivery and making government accountable and transparent (social accountability). Developing two sub-objectives allowed for the design of a targeted RF with indicators clearly linked to the sub-objectives. The two project components, social sensitization (component 1) and social accountability and social mobilization & participatory service delivery (component 2), both supported the priority post Ebola needs (PDO). The performance of the project can be judged by assessing the achievement of the two components

22. **The project was successful in achieving its PDO sub-objectives.** All outcome indicators were reached, if not exceeded. All four core and seven intermediate PDO results indicators were met, and, in most cases, the end-line target was exceeded (see Table 2 below). Activities under the two project components were delivered in support of the PDO despite implementation challenges, such as the disruptions caused by the election in 2018 and its impact on some staff changes both at DecSec and at the LC level and the recent COVID-19 pandemic, which temporarily interrupted implementation in the first half of 2020. These achievements were largely due as a result of working with staff¹⁴ and agencies who had the experience from previous Bank interventions in delivering decentralized services.

Table 2: JSDF Project Outcome Indicators Status

Outcome Indicator Name	Baseline	Original Target	Actual at Completion	Change (%)
Indicator 1: Beneficiaries who affirm social sensitization activities have been positive toward bringing people together in the four districts in which social sensitization activities are conducted (percentage)	0	65	75.3	116
Indicator 2: Sectors in Community Monitoring Initiative pilot districts assessed quarterly and managed considering citizen feedback (number)	0	10	10	100
Indicator 3: Beneficiaries who affirm participatory budgeting processes generated a positive social mobilization effect in the two districts in which participatory budgeting is conducted (percentage) ¹⁵	0	65	89.5	138
Indicator 4: Direct project beneficiaries (number) Women beneficiaries (percentage)	0	50,000 (50)	50,485 (50)	101 (50.5)

Source: Indicators 1 and 3 are from December 2020 Beneficiaries Assessment; indicators 2 and 4 are from PFMU.

23. In addition, the project included different intermediate results that supported the achievement of the PDO sub-objectives as follows:

24. **Component 1 supported the PDO's emphasis on responding to the post- EVD needs at the local level in Sierra Leone through a series of awareness-raising interventions:** (a) Social cohesion and sensitization training (Intermediate Result Indicator 1). The project reached 534 beneficiaries which surpassed the end-line target of 200 participants¹⁶ which included Local Councilors,¹⁷ WDC members,¹⁸ traditional healers,¹⁹ and religious leaders²⁰. These beneficiaries were

trained on social cohesion and social sensitization. This achievement further supports the project PDO sub-objective by building local capacities and increased local ownership to respond to post-EVD needs; (b) Trauma and sensitization interventions (Intermediate Result Indicator 2). Reports from DecSec and PFMU indicate that 38,249 beneficiaries benefited from LC trauma and sensitization interventions (51% females), surpassing the end-line target of 25,000 beneficiaries²¹. In addition, a two-day national forum was organized for the four beneficiary LCs, which created a platform for Ebola survivors to come together and discuss issues (problems and challenges) affecting their welfare and make recommendations. This forum contributed to improving social cohesion in the pilot localities by raising awareness, myth-busting and improving community solidarity.

25. Prior to the project launch, the communities in the four project districts experienced conflicts due to the discrimination and stigma associated with Ebola survivors and their families, as noted by the Beneficiary Assessment (BA). Social sensitization activities focused on easing this challenge. The BA provides additional evidence supporting this statement "at least 85 percent of the beneficiaries believe that they are now accepted and reintegrated in their community" (see Annex 4 Supporting document (B): Impact of sensitization activity). This can be attributed to the effectiveness and high attendance rate at sensitization meetings as the BA indicates that 87.5 percent of project beneficiaries confirmed they attended capacity-building and community-sensitization meetings or activities organized by the project where Ebola and other health messages were discussed.²²

26. BA confirmed increased awareness of EVD-related issues. According to the 2020 BA, 85.5 percent of beneficiaries interviewed in all the four Councils believed that community sensitization activities in the capacity building component helped them better understand EVD-related issues and better prevent contracting future diseases of a similar nature. The project's focus not only in bringing about reconciliation and healing but also increasing their knowledge and understanding on the prevention of EVD and other disasters and shocks in their communities and introducing them to community mobilization and sensitization skills. It further strengthened local ownership in the process of bringing healing and reintegration to the affected groups.

27. Commemorating EVD victims. For the first time in Sierra Leone, properly articulated and planned community-support initiatives were rolled out to foster grieving and mourning processes following a national disaster (EVD). Through the project, joint memorial services, memorial tree plantings, and dedication of community projects in honor of victims of EVD and mudslides (took place in August 2017, killing over 1,000 people). These initiatives were launched in 2018 in the four targeted LCs providing a platform for community-support initiatives to foster grieving and mourning processes. According to the project's annual report, 2018 and 2019 (Component 1), a total of 3,000 people, of which 60 percent were women, attended these events. The second set of memorial services were held in December 2019. A total of 2,000 people

¹⁴ DecSec managed to retain key staff who had operational and technical experience and were able to roll out project implementation despite the departure of some of the DecSec staff.

¹⁵ Indicator 3 benefited significantly from sensitization activities and positive spillovers to neighboring communities. This in turn led to higher uptake which contributed to the significant achievement of this indicator.

¹⁶ Given the importance of this activity more Local councilors and Ward community members attended these events.

¹⁷ The Local Council (LC) constitute the political and development authority of the locality

¹⁸ The Ward Committee (WDC) is the lowest level of the decentralized structure responsible for monitoring development and governance at their level. Each LC is constituted by WDC representatives

¹⁹ Traditional Healers have a history and influence their communities, culminating from the services they provide. Their participation and support for the community mobilization and sensitization activities was valuable in ensuring success.

²⁰ The religious leaders are held at high esteem in the societies and also have large following.

²¹ The Source of this figure is from Data Collected during implementation of Project Activities and reported to the team by the M&E specialist.

²² Beneficiary Assessment Report, December 2020.

attended, of which 70 percent were women. Caps, T-shirts, banners, and wristbands for the official memorial service ceremony with council inscriptions were distributed to community members. The activities supported the project PDO sub-objectives by helping communities to overcome the trauma of EVD and the difference between and among family members. It also brought communities and families back together and created a conducive environment for social cohesion and reconciliation.

28. Communication tools between MDAs and CSOs were maintained (Intermediate Result Indicator 3). The full engagement of all MDAs and CSOs in project activities, through telephone calls, letters, emails, and WhatsApp messages, guaranteed communication and cross-fertilization since the onset of the project. The communication tools resulted in effective coordination efforts to maintain the engagement of four CSOs to support the social sensitization and mobilization activities²³. These activities supported the PDO sub-objective by improving citizen engagement through engaging CSOs.

29. The CSOs worked in close collaboration with the LCs and DecSec to implement Components 1 and 2. They specifically participated in the design of reporting mechanisms on community dialogue (facilitating sessions) and identifying village-level community structures to help resolve grievances identified during community dialogue. In addition, CSOs also helped in the identification of community-based groups to undertake community-based monitoring and evaluation on grievance prevention, and the sensitization of the communities on the rationale of the project and their roles and responsibilities.

30. Sub-component 2A contributed towards responding to the post- EVD needs at the local level in Sierra Leone, particularly improving social accountability (PDO sub-objective), by supporting social mobilization through scaling up CMI activities. The RTFs at the LC level and key officials of LCs and CSOs were trained on social accountability, the CMI, and Grievance Redress Mechanism (GRM) concepts. Reports from the DecSec indicated that about 20,234 citizens participated in social accountability initiatives in the CMI in the pilot districts. This surpassed the end-line value of 20,000 (Intermediate Result Indicator 5). The LC Social Accountability (LCSA) teams and facilitators established 15 Community Monitoring Groups (CMGs) in Port Loko District and 15 in FCC. There were a total of 260 people in the CMGs representing both districts (with 64% female representation²⁴). Each district was allocated SLL60,000,000 to start the intervention, and funds were delivered to the CMGs/LCSA Teams to monitor and review the proposals and compacts (an agreement between the community and service providers on how to improve on service delivery). The project recruited 16 facilitators for FCC and 15 for Port Loko District²⁵ to work with LCSA teams to implement the project interventions. This intervention supports the PDO sub-objective by strengthening the trust of the beneficiary community and created new opportunities for citizens to influence the direction of policy and led to increased participation (as indicated in the Results Framework) of beneficiaries in the LCs' annual development activities.

31. The CMI approach supported strengthening bottom-up accountability through facility scorecards and community monitoring of health facilities, taking inspiration in part from a groundbreaking study demonstrating a 30 percent drop in child mortality when this methodology was used.²⁶ CMI building on the model predicated under the DSDP2 project in two districts (Western Area and Port Loko) and strengthening monitoring and accountability to ensure effective service

²³ The four CSOs are: Health Alert (FCC); the Women's Network for Environmental Sustainability group (Western Area Rural District); the Sierra Leone Social Aid Volunteers (Port Loko District); the TINAP for Peace and Development Organization (Bombali District)

²⁴ According to information from DecSec team on Dec 20th, 2020

²⁵ Information is obtained from DecSec team (Community Monitoring Initiative (CMI) Update report)

²⁶ M. Bjorkman and J. Svensson, "Power to the People: Evidence from a Randomized Experiment on Community-Based Monitoring in Uganda," *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 124/2 (2009), pp. 735–769.

delivery in four sectors: health, water, solid waste management and education sectors. Activities included the formation and training of 30 CMGs, 10²⁷ refresher training of District Coordinators and CMI Facilitators and the provision of additional monitoring manuals. In addition, the project strengthened WDC, who were instrumental in mediating between communities and LCs (an important aspect of social accountability). The project worked with stakeholders at the central and local levels to improve communication, information dissemination, and performance monitoring which enhanced the access of service delivery. The component also facilitated the implementation of a GRM across the four LCs to help resolve grievances related to project implementation.²⁸ The GRM platform was set up to quickly respond to and resolve grievances emanating from the implementation of the project and provided an effective feedback loop. The BA data indicates that 75 percent of beneficiaries interviewed were aware of GRM activities related to LC project activities. According to a report from the DecSec team²⁹ by the end of the project, 51 GRM cases were received from the four districts, all of the cases were resolved within an average of 9 days. The speed in resolution can be attributed to the knowledge and experience gained under the DSDP2 by the project team which was applied to the JSDF GRM process. The project contributed to respond to post-EVD needs at the local level by: (a) improving the trust between beneficiary communities and the LCs; (b) building state-citizen interfaces on public service delivery and community-based platform underpinned by structured social accountability mechanisms; and (c) facilitating knowledge and learning to enhance the effectiveness of project interventions.

32. The BA revealed high satisfaction with CMI monitored projects. According to the assessment, 83.3 percent of respondents reported improvement in the projects monitored by the CMGs. This intervention created institutional structures such as the LCSA committee at the LC level and CMG at the community level. These structures will serve as foundations for deepening transparency and social accountability in local governance and development, particularly in monitoring national service delivery programs being rolled out by the GoSL. The CMI further supported the PDO sub-objectives by transforming the relationship between communities and public service duty-holders, allowing citizens to express their voice and agency and ensuring the services were demand-driven.

33. The PB contributed to the project development objective to respond to the post-EVD needs at the local level in Sierra Leone, particularly improving social accountability (PDO sub-objective), by enabling an increased number of citizens to fully participate in the decision-making processes of the target LCs by identifying and prioritizing their own needs in the LCs' annual development plans for the year 2020. Monitoring the number of beneficiaries in the PB pilot is the main PB intermediate indicator. The World Bank December 2020 virtual final implementation support mission and Third-party Monitoring (TPM) and implementing agency monitoring indicated that the end-line target of 5,000 beneficiaries participating in the PB was surpassed by 4,834³⁰, reaching a total of 9,834 beneficiaries by the end of the project (Intermediate Result Indicator 6). This intermediate indicator highlighted that the component supported the PDO by increasing community engagement in service delivery.

34. However, this component 2B (PB) included several activities that were critical for achieving the PDO sub-objective. By Project closure, the project financed 16 PB sub-projects by allocating resources reflecting demand-driven community priorities. The PB sub-projects supported several sectors ranging from health (4 sub-projects), education (5 sub-projects) to water and sanitation (4 sub-projects) and food security (1 sub-project) (see Annex 4 Supporting document (D): PB

²⁷ According to the activity sheet: component 2A

²⁸ FCC, Ward C, Port Loko District Council and Bombali District Council

²⁹ This information was obtained from communication with the M&E specialist (Collina) on April 28th 2021.

³⁰ The number was collected by M&E officers in the field sent to PFMU and verified through joint supervision missions

sectors distribution and Annex 4 (E) and (F): PB sub-projects in Port Loko and FCC).

35. The PB initiative supported rehabilitation of existing facilities coupled with capacity building, information, communication and education (IEC). A five-day training was organized for WDCs in each pilot district on the PB process, information dissemination, community mobilization, conflict resolution report writing, and preparation of simple project budgets. All CSOs were trained and supported in carrying out a need-assessments for the preparation of PB proposals. A three-day training/workshop was conducted in each of the pilot councils to strengthen the capacity of WDC members in the five selected wards to help deliver high-level participation in the PB process. Jingles, posters, and radio talks were prepared in Krio and the local languages of the target communities on the PB objective and process. The WDCs were supported to screen and prepare sub-projects proposals and budgets and to prioritize sub-projects in line with the selection criteria in the project operational manual. Culturally sensitive IEC materials were developed to raise community awareness, with the outbreak of COVID-19 in 2020, the materials were tailored to inform communities on COVID-19 protocols and help mitigate the outbreak. This was done in the 10 selected Wards in FCC and Port Loko District. The specific IEC materials produced included 10 roll-up banners with messages on PB and COVID-19 protocols; 10 flex banners with messages for the PB and COVID-19; 100 stickers with culturally sensitive messages on the PB and COVID-19; 7 audio Jingles in key local languages with messages on the PB and COVID-19; and 3 sensitization videos using local languages on the PB and COVID-19 (see Annex 4 Supporting document (H): Photos of PB, Communication materials).

36. PB catalyzed a grassroots bottom-up approach. The implementation of the PB in the two districts demonstrated that citizen engagement could effectively strengthen service delivery through a demand-driven bottom-up approach, build trust, transparency, and accountability while ensuring resources are utilized transparently for the intended purposes. According to the BA, about 94.3 percent of beneficiaries agreed that the PB processes generated positive social mobilization in the two districts in which it was implemented. The IE indicated that over 84.3 percent of beneficiaries in FCC and Port Loko District affirmed that PB processes positively impacted their ability to influence LC spending priorities. The IE disclosed that participants at the Focused Group Discussions (FGDs) confirmed their LC development plans reflected community priorities since the onset of the JSDF-supported project. They attributed this to WDC members, community service organizations, and community-based organization's participation in the finalization of the LC's development planning and budgeting processes which also strengthened trust between LCs, WDCs and their constituents. The project prioritization process boosted the community ownership and in turn, the future sustainability of these investments. An unintended outcome of the PB initiative was confirmation by civil society leaders namely that the PB processes led to their inclusion and acceptance within the communities as budget interlocutors.

37. Complementarity between PB, CMI and GRM interventions. Through joint activities (sensitization, training, and monitoring), PB (16 projects), CMI (62 projects) and the GRM were complementary and served as a basis for increasing the inclusion of marginalized groups, especially women, youth, EVD survivors, people living with disabilities, and the elderly in monitoring LCs' development activities and in making decisions on critical interventions. Component 2 activities supported the PDO by contributing to building trust and intra-communal cohesion where it had been compromised, increased social mobilization, and made local social services more responsive to citizen needs in the post-EVD environment. The project facilitated knowledge and learning, which enhanced the effectiveness of interventions.

38. The JSDF activities did not overlap with ongoing donor/partner interventions in Port Loko District and Western Area Rural District with activities being implemented by: (1) the Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA) *Capacity Development for Comprehensive District Development Project*; (2) and the Foreign Common Wealth Development Office (FCDO) *Strengthening Community-Led Accountability to Improve Service Delivery in the Western Rural and Urban Areas*

Project. From 2009 to 2018, the JICA project constructed one primary school and rehabilitated two primary schools in Wards 199 and 200 in Port Loko District. The FCDO project focused on improving social accountability and better service delivery through citizen engagement from 2016 to March 2021.

39. Total number of beneficiaries benefiting from the project. Approximately 50,485 beneficiaries benefited from the project³¹, which exceeds the end-line target of 50,000 beneficiaries.³² The project created opportunities for stakeholders to benefit from the project directly, including training, coaching and mentoring, workshops/forums, direct funding for activity implementation, and distribution of materials and equipment. All of these activities and achievements have supported the PDO sub-objectives by engaging a large share of the communities to respond to the post-EVD needs at the local level.

40. Establishing a responsive, inclusive and transparent citizen-centric mechanism. The project demonstrated that decentralization, community participation in a community-driven social safety net project, and building local government capacity are integral to making service delivery responsive, inclusive, transparent and creates an avenue for gender participation (i.e., strengthening women's voice and agency) in prioritizing service delivery.

41. In conclusion, the project introduced a viable and effective community participatory service delivery safety net mechanism in Sierra Leone at a critical juncture. This model is being anchored in various decentralization and service delivery interventions nationwide.

Justification of Overall Efficacy Rating

42. Efficacy is rated **High**. The project achieved the objective of responding to the post-EVD needs at the local level in Sierra Leone. It did so through the two PDO sub-objectives (improving social sensitization and social accountability). The introduction of sensitization and awareness-raising activities, CMI, GRM and PB is rated **High** because of the innovation and improvements noted in community inclusion, participation, transparency and enhanced voice and agency of women in prioritizing service delivery. These interventions responded to the post-EVD needs at the local level in Sierra Leone by enhancing LC capacity to deliver services to the target population, especially during the COVID-19 restrictions. Taken together, the overall efficacy rating is **High**.

C. EFFICIENCY

Assessment of Efficiency and Rating

43. The overall efficiency of the project is evaluated by: (i) cost-effectiveness of activities relative to alternatives; (ii) project administrative costs; and (iii) implementation efficiency.

44. Economic Analysis. No ex-ante economic impact analysis was prepared for the JSDF and efficiency-related data are limited under the program, which makes it difficult to undertake a complete economic analysis. Contracting processes took place in a timely manner and all sub-projects under participatory budgeting (16)³³ involving civil works were completed. The project did not experience any cost overruns in the initial contract amounts, as the implementing agency

³¹ According to the World Bank December 2020 virtual final implementation support mission and virtual monitoring of end of project closing

³² Data are obtained from the M&E officers in an internal communication on June 15th, 2021. The breakdown of the 50,845 project beneficiaries is as follows: the project launching ceremonies (992 beneficiaries), Component 1 (18,659 beneficiaries), Component 2A (11,048 beneficiaries), and Component 2B (19,786 beneficiaries.) Due to COVID and some of the limitations in conducting additional verification, there is a slight possibility of overcounting or undercounting number of beneficiaries benefiting from the project activities.

³³ Nine sub-projects in FCC and seven sub-projects in Port Loko District.

incorporated lessons learned from DSDP2 to help mitigate cost overruns.

45. **Cost-effectiveness.** Participatory decision-making at the local level ensured that scarce resources were applied efficiently in response to local priorities, promoted local ownership of sub-projects, which combined with other complementary JSDF activities (such as a capacity building), made the sub-projects more amenable to being sustainable (i.e. community monitoring and ownership in fostering operations and maintenance). It is also expected to extend the life of the investments' benefits. The project consistently matched DSDP2 cost-efficiencies and outperformed the government funded projects (see Annex 4 Supporting documents (E & F): JSDF PB sub-projects in Port Loko and FCC, for a cost comparison.) Its cost-efficiencies can be partly attributed to the participatory budgeting process for sub-projects (i.e., community labor, in-kind contributions, community monitoring, and GRM) and to economies of scale from simultaneously implementing multiple sub-projects as compared to single government implementation of sub-project which are more costly. JSDF projects also completed activities 1.5-3 times faster,³⁴ with strong community participation and monitoring; support/monitoring by DecSec, FDD, PFMU, and a TPM consultant; and strong LC ownership.

46. **Administrative Efficiency.** JSDF project management costs were lower than similar operations. The administrative costs to manage the PFMU were US\$205,371, representing 7.5 percent of total disbursements (US\$2,746,253). This is at the low end of the range for such projects and is attributed to: (i) the presence of an existing and operational PCU financed by GoSL; (ii) absence of procuring capital items such as vehicles; and (iii) no payroll cost to the project as this was covered by the GoSL. An IFAD study comparing administrative costs of community service delivery projects found costs ranging from 10 to 24 percent, with average administrative costs of 16 percent.

47. **Implementation Efficiency.** JSDF appraisal estimates were benchmarked against DSDP2, and its scope was aligned with existing national- and local-level capacities. Despite delays resulting from elections in 2018, which led to staff changes at DecSec and LCs, and the outbreak of COVID-19 in 2020, the project was approved on February 6, 2017 and became effective on June 27, 2017. All activities were completed by December 27, 2020 (project close) and completion certificates were awarded to the respective sub-project LCs in Port Loko District and FCC.

48. **Overall efficiency rating.** Project activities were efficient. The above findings revealed a lower cost in implementing JSDF sub-projects as compared to GoSL sub-projects. The administrative cost was below the average cost of similar activities. Despite exogenous events that led to delays (i.e., staff turnover, procurement delays and COVID-19 pandemic), all activities were completed by the original closing date. For all these reasons, overall efficiency is rated **Substantial**.

D. OVERALL OUTCOME RATING

49. The overall outcome rating for the project is Satisfactory based on **High Relevance** of the PDO throughout implementation, the **High** rating under *Efficacy* demonstrated in the achievements attributable to project activities, innovations and responsiveness, and the **Substantial** rating for *Efficiency* as evidenced by the notable results achieved in the cost effectiveness, administrative, and implementation efficiency. In combining these ratings, and in line with the ICR Guidelines, the overall outcome rating is **Highly Satisfactory**.

³⁴ This calculation is based on data provided by FDD and TPM findings.

E. OTHER OUTCOMES AND IMPACTS

- The project highlighted the feasibility of creating partnerships between national, local and community groups in identifying and prioritizing their needs.
- The participatory budgeting pilot in FCC and Port Loko District created a demonstration effect. It displayed citizen engagement in the service delivery decision-making process and supported CMLs being replicated in other LCs.
- Communities strengthened the citizen-government social contract through, for instance, contributing their human capital and local resources were needed for timely completion of works.
- Communities received short-term economic benefits through short-term employment and thorough procurement of local materials for PB sub-projects which stimulated the local economy.
- Despite the fact that the project did not focus on trauma healing, activities did contribute to reducing psychological stress by EVD survivors and their families. Based on anecdotal information, the ICR team was informed that communities increased productivity and earnings, spawning inclusive development such as the rice-processing hubs in Marampa Chiefdom (Port Loko District) and Kambia Town (Kambia District), leading to improved income opportunities.
- Communities monitored 62 projects in FCC (22 projects) and Port Loko (40 projects)³⁵ covering a range of sectors from health and education to water/sanitation and agriculture, this is a precursor to their engagement in setting up operations and monitoring committees thus creating a mechanism for sustainability³⁶.
- Communities envisioned and implemented multi-faceted interventions, such as raising awareness of free GoSL healthcare services for EBV victims and their families at memorial services and alerting them to possible linkages with other relevant government programs.
- The project supported an adaptive response to service delivery during the COVID-19 response in the selected districts. The adaptive framework allowed for partnerships with national, sub-national government agencies and communities to be strengthened as outlined in the 2017 Development Operational Guidelines of the Ministry of Local Government and Rural Development Local Council.
- The project also supported building the procurement capacity of communities and LCs by training 20 local government officials and 50 community members under the participatory budgeting activities. This expedited implementation and led to improved transparency³⁷.
- The lessons learned have been catalytic in rolling out the new GoSL decentralization policy. Specifically, objective (e) of the policy, which supports the "promotion of the wellbeing of local citizens, especially of marginalized groups such as women, youth, and people living with disabilities, by giving them a greater role in participation in the planning, implementation, and evaluation of local development plans."
- **COVID-19.** The positive spillover from the project's capacity-building efforts drawing on Ebola interventions proved to be instrumental in helping pilot communities respond to the COVID-19 pandemic. Communities in the project districts responded proactively to prevent the pandemic from spreading in their localities. In Port Loko and Bombali Districts, very few COVID-19 cases were reported as compared to the Western Area. In the Western Area, the most populous region with a population of nearly 1.5 million people, only 2,900 people (0.19 percent)

³⁵ Data obtained from internal communication with the client M&E specialist for component 2 on June 11th, 2021

³⁶ Data are collected from reports from the District Coordinators in Freetown and Port Loko 2018-2020

³⁷ Data obtained from the M&E team at DecSec in an internal communication on June 8th, 2021. (the time stated that the data are from various training reports)

were infected as of May 30, 2021.³⁸ According to the 2020 BA, 85.5 percent of beneficiaries interviewed in all the four Councils believed that community sensitization activities in the capacity building component helped them better understand EVD-related issues and better prevent contracting future diseases of a similar nature such as COVID-19. The role of project interventions, inclusive of applying to Ebola response protocols, hygiene maintenance, and generating support from LCs, key national agencies and other stakeholders in combatting the pandemic, contributed to containing the disease in these districts.

Poverty and Shared Prosperity

50. The JSDF project introduced a community participatory safety net approach to support EVD survivors and their families. It helped asset creation through public works, skills development during COVID-19 under the PB sub-projects and improved access to services by the end-users in the pilot districts. The implementation of 16 PB sub-projects created employment for 251 people in both FCC and Port Loko PB sub-projects, with females representing 35 percent of total employed (see Annex 4 Supporting document (G): Number of people employed in PB community sub-projects.) It supported complementary interventions by GoSL, the Bank, and partners targeting improvements in human capital outcomes by: (i) allowing communities to prioritize their service delivery needs in health, education, etc., improve access which in turn are crucial elements for closing the human capital gap; (ii) promoting behavioral change through behavioral sensitization, awareness-raising workshops which helped increase demand for health and education services under the participatory budgeting sub-component; (iii) building social accountability platforms to strengthen grievances; and (iv) improving crisis-response systems to mitigate the impact of shocks and disasters as seen during the recent COVID-19 pandemic and project response in the pilot districts building on the project's post-EVD sensitization efforts.

Gender

51. The project supported the World Bank Gender Strategy objectives 1 "supporting human endowments (health, education and social protection" and objective 4 "enhancing women's voice and agency and engaging men and boys Project indicators were designed to capture gender-disaggregated data³⁹). Fifty percent of beneficiaries were women, as reported in the baseline assessment, which aligned with the end of project target. Seventy percent of the respondents in the IE survey⁴⁰ confirmed that women were fully involved in the activities promoted by CSOs and the LCs under the project.⁴¹ The project developed a gender-mainstreaming strategy and uniformly integrated, implemented, and monitored gender parity across project activities. The strategy was transacted through training, operations manual, IEC and outreach materials, CMI, and GRM. Officials of the four LCs and selected CSOs received training, mentoring, and coaching on the principles outlined in the gender strategy. A three-day workshop was organized in November 2018 by the DecSec at the Port Loko District to anchor the guiding principles of the strategy and gender perspectives of the project in the implementation of project activities. The operations manual clearly spelled out that women constitute at least half of the decision-making committee for identifying, planning/budgeting, and implementing activities. The project empowered women to assume leadership positions with 79.3%⁴² of women taking on key responsibilities in the CMG forums. Communication outreach materials were socially and culturally appropriate, tailored to literacy levels, and timed for

38 Population numbers were obtained from Statistics Sierra Leone (<https://www.statistics.sl/>) "2015 Population and Housing Census Final Results" and number of COVID cases are obtained from Directorate of Health Security and Emergencies Ministry of Health And Sanitation (<https://dhse.gov.sl/>)

39 World Bank Group Gender Strategy (FY16-23)

40 Difference in female percentage between the RF and IE can be attributed to the smaller sample size of the IE

41 For example, in December 2020, the JSDF project team interviewed officials of the Port Loko District CSO Collective Development Initiative and confirmed gender parity was observed in its activities.

42 CMI District Coordinators Reports, January 2019 and January,2020: Women in Leadership

maximal access and inclusion. The project executed gender parity in training, CMGs, and social-sensitization interventions. By strengthening their voice and agency, women were empowered and were given the forum to express grievances.

52. High female participation in the CMGs. Of the 260 people participating in the 30 CMGs in both FCC and Port Loko, 65 percent were females vis-à-vis 35 percent males. About 70 percent of the respondents in the IE survey confirmed that women were fully involved in the activities promoted by CSOs and the LCs under the project.⁴³ In addition, PB sub-projects also benefited females, particularly in the education sector. In the 5 rehabilitated schools in Port Loko, 51 percent of the student were girls (1,079 out of 2,116) (see Annex 4 Supporting document (E): JSDF PB Sub Projects in Port Loko.) Sensitization activities under Component 1 also showed strong female participation. Of the total 38,249 participants, 51% were female (19,368 females and 18,881 males.) (see Annex 4 Supporting document (A): breakdown of beneficiaries reached through sensitization interventions, by gender.) Finally, an auxiliary outcome of the project was creating short-term employment for women under the PB sub-projects. Thirty-five percent of the beneficiaries employed under the PB sub-projects were women (see Annex 4 Supporting document (G): The Number of people employed in PB community sub-projects).

Institutional Strengthening

53. The JSDF project built on existing DSDP2 service delivery institutional arrangements. The JSDF project provided resources to deepen DSDP2 demand-driven approaches to service delivery reflected by strong social accountability, community monitoring, GRM, and effective partnerships with CSOs and national and local government. The project is built on the premise that strengthening institutions is key to laying the foundations for higher and more sustainable economic growth, which can help reduce the drivers and impact of fragility, conflict, and violence.

54. The project strengthened inter-ministerial coordination at the policy level and intergovernmental coordination. Despite initial resistance, the ministers of Agriculture, Finance, Health, Local Government, and Social Welfare signed an inter-ministerial Memorandum of Understanding to strengthen information flows and preempt mitigating bottlenecks. This inter-ministerial forum provided the necessary space to craft policy, streamline implementation, and build sustainability. The project also deepened intergovernmental coordination setting a precedent for the operationalization of the new decentralization strategy.

55. The project scaled up key DSDP2 activities to consolidate gains made in service delivery by placing a premium on social accountability, in line with the Bank's CAS and SCD recommendations and GoSL country development agenda. These activities included: (i) providing training to LCs, communities, and local leaders on resilience to shocks; (ii) launching citizen dialogue to strengthen inclusion and community resilience; (iii) organizing mourning ceremonies and memorial services in honor of Ebola victims bringing about reconciliation and mitigating stigma; (iv) creating over 30 CMGs in key Wards to supervise public services; and (v) instituting a two-tier grievances redress mechanism to provide a voice to citizens on local services delivery challenges.

56. The project designed an effective, replicable road map for sustainable community participation and responsive national and local government partnerships. The project interventions were incorporated under Pillar 8 of the Sierra Leone Medium-Term National Development Plan 2019-2023. This will continue to strengthen citizen engagement, social accountability, and transparency in service delivery and integrated community demands in LC development plans in turn

⁴³ For example, in December 2020, the JSDF project team interviewed officials of the Port Loko District CSO Collective Development Initiative and confirmed gender parity was observed in its activities.

bolstering the safety net dimension of community-led development.

III. KEY FACTORS THAT AFFECTED IMPLEMENTATION AND OUTCOME

KEY FACTORS DURING PREPARATION

57. **Design of objectives and activities.** The PDO was aligned with the post-EVD context and the GoSL's development agenda in Sierra Leone as were the components which were well structured, had clear operational logic, were relevant and drew on lessons learned from DSDP2 in designing social accountability platforms (GRM and CMI). During the design phase, the Bank team engaged extensively with partners, national, local, CSO, and community representatives to consult on the design and align the design with the local needs and priorities. While the post Ebola needs are not limited to the PDO sub-objectives, the project activities were designed to respond to the post-EVD needs that were: (a) priorities for the Client; (b) fall within the parameters of the JSDF financing guidelines; and (c) complement other interventions. The sequencing of tasks was also adequate, and implementing agencies had the capacity to manage project activities at appraisal, given their extensive engagement in the DSDP1 and 2 projects. The project design included extensive training, inputs and logistics, financial support, and sensitization for communities and LCs to partner in project coordination. An inter-agency committee developed at the LC level supported community interventions and coordinated CMI and GRM activities.

58. **The project catalyzed community engagement in prioritizing service delivery under the participatory budgeting framework.** This innovation was well-received by all stakeholders; however, additional time should have been factored into project design to allow communities and local institutions to absorb and adapt to a demand-driven approach. For instance, the PB launch was delayed and started around July 2020 due to procurement delays and COVID-19 restrictions. In contrast, the GRM,⁴⁴ CMI and other sensitization activities were rolled out and implemented early on during project implementation. Nevertheless, all project activities were completed by project closing.

59. **Results framework (RF).** Indicators, baselines and targets for the RF benefitted from the institutional arrangements and lessons learned from the DSDP2 and were appropriate for the intended project objective and related outcomes. The project put in place a structured monitoring plan to collect information on the project achievements. At the preparation stage, an agreement was reached with the GoSL to continue with the implementation of the Integrated National Public Services Survey (INPSS)⁴⁵ and Comprehensive Local Government Performance Assessment System (CLOGPAS)⁴⁶ surveys developed under the DSDP1 and DSDP2 projects. However, constrained resources precluded this approach. The project team adopted the next-best alternative: a baseline and end-line BA complemented by an end-of-project impact evaluation. On the other hand, the PDO was such that it needed to be defined by two sub-objectives which allowed for a more targeted RF.

60. **Risks and mitigation measures.** The risks and mitigation measures identified during preparation were largely adequate. Identifying risks of stakeholder over-expectation in the planning phase would have benefitted the

44 For instance, all 51 complaints reported under the JSDF GRM were addressed and closed by the project closure. The 51 cases were resolved within the stipulated time frame of 22 days and 3 cases lasted for 30 days.

45 INPSS was a nationally representative annual survey that tracked progress on the basic services that DSDP1 and 2 supported.

46 CLOGPAS was a key survey used to measure improvements in the capacity of LCs.

project. The stakeholders expected remuneration for services provided under the project, such as offsetting the costs of fuel, transportation, and food to attend the meetings and remunerating attendance. The EVD victims expected the project to provide direct income to support improvements in livelihoods, which was not part of the project design. This risk was mitigated through follow-up sensitization sessions to address grievances where the implementing agencies engaged in consultations with communities and local leadership to clarify the intended scope and design of the project. In addition, the Bank team reached out to FDD, PFMU, and complementary Bank projects (i.e. Social Safety Net) to identify potential linkages to support livelihood and other social services to EVD survivors and their families. The FDD team were able to establish linkages for some of the EVD survivors and their families to key social service programs.

KEY FACTORS DURING IMPLEMENTATION

Factors subject to government and/or implementing entities control

61. **Governance/Human Resources.** The project encountered staffing challenges at the local and national levels around the 2018 elections. In the lead-up to elections, the project team partially implemented activities to ensure effective utilization of project resources and to achieve the intended results. In the aftermath of the elections, Aide-Memoires indicate that four core DecSec staff were relieved; and LC leadership were changed. The positions at DecSec were not replaced for six months. This incurred significant institutional memory loss and increased costs for training and social-sensitization interventions for the new staff from the staff that were retained in DecSec. The presence of the core and experienced DecSec staff was a key factor for catalyzing implementation after the impasse resulting from these institutional changes. Future Bank engagement should ensure there are contingency clauses in contracts to manage these types of risks and that dedicated staff are retained under the project.

62. **Intergovernmental ownership and coordination.** As mentioned above, the project was strategic in solidifying ownership of the activities through a Memorandum of Understanding among the five key public stakeholders. This mechanism facilitated face-to-face discussions and vertical and horizontal data/information flows among ministries, departments, and agencies. This proved to be key to furthering the implementation of innovative mechanisms such as participatory budgeting.

63. **Procurement.** The PFMU had a designated procurement staff for the project who was also working on other projects. The work overload on the procurement specialist lead to delays in procurement timelines and uploading requests into the Systematic Tracking of Exchanges in Procurement (STEP). Technical assistance from Procurement Bank specialists helped resolve and expedite procurement delays as well as the experience of the procurement specialist.

64. **M&E.** The project maximized the human capital and infrastructure accumulations of DSDP2 for M&E, facilitating the collection, use, and reporting of data. The project adopted the next-best alternatives to offset resource constraints to undertaking the INPSS and CLOGPAS survey, using baseline and end-line beneficiary surveys complemented by an end-of-project impact evaluation.

Factors subject to World Bank control

65. **Adequacy of supervision.** Bank task team leaders did not change. The core Bank team and client at the PFMU, FDD and a segment of key DecSec staff working on DSDP2 were involved in supervision, which allowed for collective

resolution of problems in an expeditious manner. In January 2020, the COVID-19 crisis curtailed in-person supervision by the Bank team and field visits by the implementing agencies. The project redressed this exogenous factor through intensive virtual technical and supervision missions, hiring a TPM consultant, intensive LCs engagement in the pilot districts and spaced out in-country joint supervision missions by the implementing agencies. In July/August 2020, field visits resumed and expedited the remaining activities, especially the PB pilots in FCC and Port Loko District.

66. Proactive response to align Annual Work Plans with component needs. The project adjusted the Annual Work Plan to accommodate changing budget needs to facilitate project implementation.

67. Delay in funds disbursement. Disbursements were initially slow. The release of the first tranche of funds from the Bank to GoSL was delayed six months because of systemic technical glitches; this delay rippled into the project launch timeline. An internal miscommunication between PFMU and DecSec staff in processing and clearing payments for the PB activities caused procurement delays; the Bank team intervened to resolve these issues, and as a result, significant procurement was completed in the last 18 months of the project.

68. Revising institutional arrangements and reallocating funds. The project was restructured in January 2020 based on extensive consultations at the mid-term review. The restructuring reallocated funds from sub-projects and training budgets to operating costs to supplement the implementing partner's supervision. It also added the FDD as an implementing agency with the PFMU and DecSec, which constitutes a mixed team of economists and FM, procurement, and civil works experts, to accelerate the implementation of Component 2B. The FDD's full engagement in project activities provided extensive technical and administrative capacity, filling gaps such as FM and procurement. The FDD's experience in managing the transfer of funds to LCs and in supervising LC projects led to the successful acceleration, completion, and handover of Sub-component 2B activities in FCC and Port Loko District.

Factors outside the control of government and or implementing entities

69. COVID-19 crisis. The pandemic caused delays in the implementation of program activities since the movement and gathering of people was restricted, and district, township, and offices had to close during the lockdowns. The pandemic limited stakeholder engagement initially, including with LCs, WDCs, CSOs, MDAs, women, youth, EVD survivors, people living with disabilities, and other vulnerable and marginalized groups in the target LCs. The pandemic also delayed the initial start timelines to implement PB sub-projects.

IV. BANK PERFORMANCE, COMPLIANCE ISSUES, AND RISK TO DEVELOPMENT OUTCOME

A. BANK PERFORMANCE

70. Quality at Entry. The Task Team ensured quality at entry through a context-specific project design. The Bank's performance in the identification, preparation and appraisal led to the development of a sound project design, with sufficient steps taken to strengthen project management developed under DSDP2 of the implementing agencies capacity in procurement, FM, and M&E capacity. The project objectives reflected the findings, lessons learned, and recommendations emerging from lending operations and economic and sector work in Sierra Leone. These included the "2008 IEG assessment of decentralization in client countries" and a "2009 joint report by the

Bank and the government on decentralization in Sierra Leone" as well as "A Review of World Bank Support for Accountability Institutions in the Context of Governance and Anticorruption" and "Pathways for Peace: Inclusive Approaches to Preventing Violent Conflict." Finally, the project drew on lessons learned in-country and Bank-wide for community-driven development approaches to safety net programs, as well as for potential risks to mitigate.

71. The project was relevant to and consistent with GoSL policies/priorities and the Bank strategies⁴⁷. The project designed a highly replicable – and the country's first – participatory budgeting model, with a lens toward the National Decentralization Policy (2020) and Medium-Term National Development Plan (2019-2023). The project capitalized on the Bank's ongoing civil works for implementation, such as the DSDP2 (2012-2018), especially for its citizen engagement and social accountability mechanisms, and on the Bank's past civil works for broader institutional arrangements, such as the Capacity Building Project (2004-2008) and DSDP1 (2009-2011) and built upon the Bank's community-level engagement through the National Social Action Program (NSAP). In retrospect, the PDO could have been more narrowly defined to avoid the need for sub-objectives, however, the RF was developed to show progress towards the achievement of these sub-objectives and as such the overall PDO.

72. **Quality of Supervision.** The project design was innovative, and the Bank team was agile. The Bank's comparative advantage was displayed in the array of support to the project. Bank fiduciary, procurement, and monitoring and evaluation teams redressed bottlenecks and streamlined operations. Bank technical assistance devised good-fit solutions pre-pandemic (participatory budgeting, community monitoring initiative, and base/endline assessments) and post-pandemic (virtual technical assistance and supervision, TPM) and, here, reviewing/revising training schedules, monitoring funds expended under PB pilots, and periodically training facilitators for better beneficiary support to allow timely completion of activities. Bank reporting reflected clear, cogent, and actionable supervision missions as seen through Aide Memoires and Regular Implementation Status Reports. In sum, the Bank team identified issues proactively and worked closely with the implementing agencies and counterparts to resolve issues.

73. The project highlighted the importance of being adaptive and restructuring the project to accelerate implementation and improve institutional coordination. According to the last Aide mémoire (Final Implementation Support Mission, November 30 – December 10, 2020), the JSDF restructuring led to strong teamwork and performance by the PFMU, DecSec and FDD teams in delivering results despite the constraints placed by COVID-19 and other challenges. The overall Bank performance is **Satisfactory**.

B. ENVIRONMENTAL, SOCIAL AND FIDUCIARY COMPLIANCE

74. **Safeguards.** The project retained its Category B environmental classification throughout implementation. Environmental Assessment (OP 4.01) was triggered at appraisal as a precaution due to participatory budgeting under Component 2. An Environmental and Social Management Framework (ESMF) was prepared and disclosed on the World Bank website on September 26, 2016 and in Sierra Leone on September 24, 2016. No major adverse environmental and social impacts were observed during project implementation. The overall safeguards performance of the project was rated Satisfactory in Implementation Status and Results Reports (ISRs) submitted consecutively from December 2017 to April 2020 (December 8, 2017; June 28, 2018; January 26, 2019; September 10, 2019; April 23, 2020). In the ISR submitted at project closing (December 24, 2020), overall safeguards

⁴⁷ Country Partnership Framework, Systematic Country Diagnostic, Africa Region Social Protection Strategy, and Africa Region Emergency Ebola Response Program.

performance was downgraded to Moderately Satisfactory since no Environment and Social Management Plan (ESMP) had been prepared for site works under Component 2 due to the departure of the project safeguards specialist a gap in the transition with orienting the new project safeguards specialist on the remaining tasks. Monitoring and reporting on environment and social safeguards (E&S) implementation and the project Grievance Redress Mechanism (GRM) were scaled up towards the end of the project implementation with support from the Bank safeguards specialists, with reports on E&S implementation and the GRM prepared by the project Implementing Unit in December 2020. Component 2B activities did not cause any irreversible harm. The safeguards rating at project closing is rated as ***Moderately Satisfactory***.

Financial Management (FM)

75. Over the lifetime of the JSDF project, FM was rated as ***Satisfactory***. FM reviews were conducted periodically. In general, findings revealed that the proceeds were being used for their intended purposes and, accordingly, were compliant with FM covenants. Interim financial reports (IFR) and audit reports were submitted in a timely manner and in accordance with established Bank procedures. There were no fundamental internal control issues identified in financial statements or major audit observations. Overall, funds flows, reporting, and accounting system(s) were deemed sound. Fiduciary clinics were provided throughout project implementation. Disbursement at the closing date of the project stood at US\$2,746,253.34 (99.9 percent). The FM rating at project closing thus stands as ***Satisfactory***.

Procurement

76. **Quality at Entry.** At entry, the procurement quality is rated ***Satisfactory***. In preparation, the procurement capacity assessment gave a ***Substantial*** risk rating, requiring the GoSL central fiduciary management unit to appoint a qualified focal procurement officer. Overall, in terms of procurement, issues were identified, and steps were taken to ensure the efficiency and effectiveness of procurement toward the achievement of the project development objectives. The Bank procurement team provided timely support to resolve procurement delays.

77. **Quality of Implementation by the Borrower.** The quality of the Borrower during implementation is rated as ***Satisfactory***. The GoSL PFMU Unit was responsible for project administration, including procurement. The PFMU performed well from beginning to closing. The project team was able to process Bank “No Objections” for prior-review contracts, including procurement plans, and to clear post-review contracts during Bank post-review missions.

Monitoring and Evaluation

78. The overall monitoring and evaluation (M&E) rating for the project is ***Substantial***. The measures put in place to track and monitor project indicators were responsive to emerging challenges. It built on the strong project monitoring platforms developed under DSDP2, which facilitated tracking progress, building transparency, detecting challenges, and adjusting interventions in a timely manner. In the pilot districts, the project had a dedicated M&E team at the PFMU, DecSec, and LC level to effectively supervise and monitor progress. These M&E specialists were key members of the DSDP2 project and their knowledge and experience in identifying risks and alerting management and the Bank team to emerging challenges were key to resolving issues. During the course of implementation, the M&E specialists benefited from hands-on training and TA from a Bank M&E specialist. The

project scaled up engagements with LCs, CSOs, and communities to resolve emerging challenges and benefited from hiring an independent TPM consultant to undertake spot checks and relay independent reporting. Collectively, these approaches led to early detection and resolution of problems and allowed the Bank team to engage quickly, especially during the COVID-19 pandemic where there were no physical supervision missions.

79. The project also scaled up the GRM and CMI mechanisms to ensure inclusion and adoption of corrective actions and to respond to and resolve the concerns of beneficiaries. There were 30 CMGs created to monitor 62 projects and the 51 complaints have been addressed through the GRM throughout project implementation. For example, in Port Loko a fire broke out in the Ebola cemetery where new trees were planted that needed replacement. This issue was escalated to the LCs through the GRM framework. The LCs took action and resolved the issue within two weeks and planted new trees in commemoration of the Ebola victims. The project also conducted baseline and end-line BAs and an impact evaluation to verify the project's impact on beneficiaries in lieu of the absence of the two key surveys that were used under DSDP2 (INPSS and CLoGPAS).

80. The project conducted regular technical review meetings, especially following the review of quarterly progress reports. The meetings enabled the project to collectively address issues and challenges identified in the specified reporting period.

Compliance Issues

Risk to Development Outcome

The risk to development outcomes is rated **Low**.

81. **Precedent-setting service delivery.** The JSDF was designed within the framework of a demonstrated government commitment to service delivery within a decentralization framework and the project was implemented through pre-existing, national structures. The project contributed to consolidating elements of the DSDP1 and DSDP2 especially related to strengthening community engagement in the service delivery process. The GoSL, in partnership with LCs, demonstrated its commitment to furthering community participation in service delivery and is scaling up demand-driven approaches. The interventions continue to be relevant to the Sierra Leone Medium-Term National Development Plan (SLMTNDP) 2019-2023 and the Bank CPF. In particular, the PB sub-component supports SLMTNDP Cluster 4 by providing opportunities to: (i) build trust in state institutions (Cluster 4.6); (ii) strengthen public service delivery and decentralization (Cluster 4.7); and (iii) solidify local governance and rural development (Cluster 4.8). The PB sub-component also supports SLMTNDP Cluster 1 by supporting the development of human capital. The framing of the JSDF within this context of ongoing government commitment helps mitigate the risk of a reversal of the outcomes.

82. **Sustainability.** CMGs ensured operations and maintenance of the rehabilitated services financed under PB in FCC and Port Loko District were addressed and plans are in place for their continued involvement in anchoring sustainability of these assets beyond the life of the project. FDD is preparing a revenue potential of local and chiefdom councils plan with a view to identifying their respective revenue potentials and strengthening their capacity to collect the revenues. These resources will be applied towards the operations and maintenance of PB sub-projects and other related project activities. In addition, FDD is preparing an asset management plan that lays out a schedule for operations and maintenance to operate and maintain the PB sub-project investments once the

local revenues have been mobilized. The Bank's recently approved "Accountable Governance for Basic Service Delivery" (to be launched in the fall of 2021) will build on the JSDF citizen engagement service delivery model.

V. LESSONS LEARNED AND RECOMMENDATIONS

83. The JSDF demonstrated the importance of coordinated action among multiple implementing agencies and using existing structures. National and local stakeholders succeeded in implementing the JSDF project. This platform demonstrated the importance of having a coordinated partnership in place to catalyze and foster partnerships between national government, LCs, and communities in responding to shocks, particularly during the Post-Ebola outbreak and COVID-19 pandemic. These arrangements could serve as a replicable, social-accountability, and participatory-budgeting model for other projects and government interventions (i.e., the National Decentralization Plan (2020) and the Medium-Term National Development Plan (2019-2023 and the new Bank Governance and Accountability Project).

84. Community engagement and shock-responsiveness. The active involvement of the community committees in project activities, including monitoring were key to enhancing community mobilization, social accountability, improved governance and transparency under the PB sub-projects. The project interventions helped build their resilience and built social cohesion.

85. Importance of using local structures. The success of the project relied on working with facilitators from the target communities and organizing support activities in the communities where the beneficiaries resided. The facilitators were selected from the same communities as the beneficiaries, and the community-based sensitization and capacity-building training made it possible for the facilitators to work closely with the beneficiaries and monitor progress, which strengthened community capacity and also bolstered social inclusion.

86. Gender inclusion. The project demonstrated the importance of mainstreaming gender in decentralized service delivery which in turn led to strengthening social cohesion and elevating the role of women in the decision making process reflecting community priorities, and strengthening their role in the CMI which helped catalyze sub-project implementation which can generate a more viable platform for future sub-project sustainability.

87. Staff attrition and leadership commitment. Proper modalities such as contingency clauses need to be included in contracts to manage risks of staff departure/attrition resulting from political transitions and draining institutional memory and implementation momentum.

88. Procurement. Additional procurement staff need to be added to support urgent project requests to avoid procurement delays.

89. Strong teamwork. The project highlighted the importance of using the restructuring process to improve institutional coordination. The JSDF restructuring led to enhanced cooperation and a strong performance by the PFMU, DecSec, and FDD teams in delivering project activities despite the constraints imposed by COVID-19 and related challenges.

90. Synergies from anchoring participatory community service delivery approaches in safety net operations. Projects Including communities in prioritizing, participating and monitoring service delivery is a key entry point in

leveraging and developing adaptive safety net programs in the FCV context. These approaches have helped restore citizen-state trust and instituted measures to strengthen social cohesion and local development priorities. In addition to Sierra Leone, this approach has been successfully implemented in other SPJ operations such as Yemen under the Emergency Crisis Response Project, Iraq Social Fund Project, Benin community-driven Development Project, Ethiopia Promoting Basic Services 3 Project, and the Northern Uganda Social Action Fund Project.

91. **Projects and Bank engagement needs to be adaptive.** This is crucial given the global and climatic changes facing many countries. During the COVID-19 pandemic, the Bank team engaged in frequent virtual supervision monthly meetings to follow up on project implementation and resolve issues. The Bank team hired a TPM to independently monitor project implementation and report back to the Bank team on any risks. This facilitated quick and timely responses. The JSDF Post Ebola project interventions (communication, sensitization and provision of hygiene supplies) proved to be relevant and timely in helping address challenges emerging as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic in the project districts.

92. **Working with civil society organizations is critical to enhancing community participation.** The involvement of the CSOs in the PB has increased community participation not only in the PB, but also in the activities of the LCs. Despite the delay in their recruitment, the CSOs were highly instrumental in the implementation of the PB. Their familiarity with the communities and expertise in social mobilization led to increased participation of the communities especially in the PB process.



ANNEX 1. RESULTS FRAMEWORK AND KEY OUTPUTS

A. RESULTS INDICATORS

A.1 PDO Indicators

Objective/Outcome: The project was designed to respond to the post-EVD needs at the local level (PDO) through two sub-objectives. Key PDO sub-objectives included: (a) enhancing social harmonization/inclusion (social sen

Indicator Name	Unit of Measure	Baseline	Original Target	Formally Revised Target	Actual Achieved at Completion
Percentage of beneficiaries who affirm social sensitization activities have been positive toward bringing people together in the four (4) districts in which sensitization activities are conducted	Percentage	0.00 23-Jun-2017	0.00 23-Jun-2017	65.00 25-Dec-2020	75.30 27-Dec-2020

Comments (achievements against targets):
Exceeded target.

Indicator Name	Unit of Measure	Baseline	Original Target	Formally Revised Target	Actual Achieved at Completion
Number of sectors in CMI piloting districts quarterly assessed and managed	Number	0.00 23-Jun-2017	0.00 23-Jun-2017	10.00 25-Dec-2020	10.00 27-Dec-2020



considering citizen feedback

Comments (achievements against targets):

Achieved. The CMI was carried out in two pilot LCs. Projects monitored were in 5 sectors (Health, Education, Social Welfare, Rural Water, and Solid Waste Management) for each LC, resulting in 10 sectors in total.

Indicator Name	Unit of Measure	Baseline	Original Target	Formally Revised Target	Actual Achieved at Completion
Percentage of beneficiaries who affirm public budgeting processes generated a positive social mobilization effect in the two (2) districts in which participatory budgeting is conducted	Percentage	0.00 23-Jun-2017	0.00 23-Jun-2017	65.00 25-Dec-2020	94.30 27-Dec-2020

Comments (achievements against targets):

Exceeded target. Data was received on 12/18/2020 from the endline beneficiary assessment.

Indicator Name	Unit of Measure	Baseline	Original Target	Formally Revised Target	Actual Achieved at Completion
Direct project beneficiaries	Number	0.00 23-Jun-2017	50000.00 23-Jun-2017	50000.00 25-Dec-2020	50485.00 27-Dec-2020
Female beneficiaries	Percentage	0.00 23-Jun-2017	50.00 23-Jun-2017	50.00 25-Dec-2020	50.00 27-Dec-2020



Comments (achievements against targets):

Exceeded target.

A.2 Intermediate Results Indicators

Component: • Component 1 – LC social-sensitization activities – sought to promote social cohesion and resilience by strengthening LC capacity and by implementing community-wide sensitization meetings, forums, an

Indicator Name	Unit of Measure	Baseline	Original Target	Formally Revised Target	Actual Achieved at Completion
Number of WDC members, LC councilors, traditional and religious healers trained on trauma healing (% of which are females)	Number	0.00 23-Jun-2017	200.00 23-Jun-2017	200.00 25-Dec-2020	534.00 27-Dec-2020

Comments (achievements against targets):

Exceeded target.

Indicator Name	Unit of Measure	Baseline	Original Target	Formally Revised Target	Actual Achieved at Completion
Number of beneficiaries reached through LC trauma and sensitization interventions (% of which are females)	Number	0.00 23-Jun-2017	25000.00 23-Jun-2017	25000.00 25-Dec-2020	38249.00 27-Dec-2020



Comments (achievements against targets):

Exceeded target.

Unlinked Indicators

Indicator Name	Unit of Measure	Baseline	Original Target	Formally Revised Target	Actual Achieved at Completion
Communication means/tools linking DHMTs, CSOs, PERS, and EERP, are maintained	Yes/No	N 23-Jun-2017	Y 23-Jun-2017	Y 25-Dec-2020	Y 27-Dec-2020

Comments (achievements against targets):

Achieved.

Indicator Name	Unit of Measure	Baseline	Original Target	Formally Revised Target	Actual Achieved at Completion
Number of RTFs and LC officers received special training on social accountability	Number	0.00 23-Jun-2017	0.00 23-Jun-2017	200.00 25-Dec-2020	203.00 27-Dec-2020

Comments (achievements against targets):

Exceeded target.

Indicator Name	Unit of Measure	Baseline	Original Target	Formally Revised Target	Actual Achieved at Completion
Number of citizens participated	Number	0.00	0.00	20000.00	20234.00



in social accountability initiatives in CMI piloted districts (% of which are females)		14-Nov-2016	23-Jun-2017	25-Dec-2020	27-Dec-2020
Comments (achievements against targets): Exceeded target.					
Indicator Name	Unit of Measure	Baseline	Original Target	Formally Revised Target	Actual Achieved at Completion
Number of beneficiaries in the participatory budgeting pilot (% of which are females)	Number	0.00 23-Jun-2017	0.00 23-Jun-2017	5000.00 25-Dec-2020	9834.00 27-Dec-2020
Comments (achievements against targets): Exceeded target.					
Indicator Name	Unit of Measure	Baseline	Original Target	Formally Revised Target	Actual Achieved at Completion
Number of joint monitoring visits to LCs, conducted by relevant MDAs	Number	0.00 23-Jun-2017	0.00 23-Jun-2017	20.00 25-Dec-2020	22.00 27-Dec-2020
Comments (achievements against targets): Exceeded target.					





B. ORGANIZATION OF THE ASSESSMENT OF THE PDO

Objective/Outcome 1	
Outcome Indicators	To respond to the post-EVD needs at the local level in Sierra Leone by building community resilience through EVD sensitization efforts and social mobilization activities in the districts most affected by the disease
Intermediate Results Indicators	1. Percentage of beneficiaries who affirm social sensitization activities have been positive toward bringing people together in the four (4) districts in which sensitization activities are conducted 2. Number of sectors in CMI piloting districts quarterly assessed and managed considering citizen feedback (Number, Custom) 3. Percentage of beneficiaries who affirm public budgeting processes generated a positive social mobilization effect in the two (2) districts in which participatory budgeting is conducted 4. Direct project beneficiaries 5. Number of WDC members, LC councilors, traditional and religious healers trained on trauma healing 6. Number of beneficiaries reached through LC trauma and sensitization interventions 7. Communication means/tools linking DHMTs, CSOs, PERS, and EERP, are maintained 8. Number of RTFs and LC officers received special training on social accountability 9. Number of citizens participated in social accountability initiatives in CMI piloted districts 10. Number of beneficiaries in the participatory budgeting pilot 11. Number of joint monitoring visits to LCs, conducted by relevant MDAs



Key Outputs by Component
(linked to the achievement of the Objective/Outcome 1)

1. 75.3% (Exceeded target)
2. 10 (Achieved target)
3. 94.30% (Exceeded target)
4. 50,485 (Exceeded target)
5. 534 (Exceeded target)
6. 38,249 (Exceeded target)
7. Yes (Achieved target)
8. 203 (Exceeded target)
9. 20,234 (Exceeded target)
10. 9,834 (Exceeded target)
11. 22 (Exceeded target)



ANNEX 2. PROJECT COST BY COMPONENT

Republic of Sierra Leone

Strengthening Community Mobilization and Local Council Service Delivery in the Post-Ebola Context Project

United States Dollars (US\$)

Disbursement by Components	Planned IDA	Project Amount Approved	Actual Amount Disbursed	Percentage Disbursed
		US\$	US\$	%
Component 1: Local Council Social Sensitization		980,000	976,743	99.67
Component 2: Creating Social Mobilization Mechanisms That Improve Local Service Delivery		1,560,000	1,564,021	100.26
Component 3: Project Management		210,000	205,371	97.80
Total Expenditures		2,750,000	2,746,135	99.86

Disbursements by Category

Disbursement by Category	Period End: April 30, 2021	Cumulative Disbursement		
	Planned IDA	Project Amount Approved	Actual Amount Disbursed	Percentage Disbursed
		US\$	US\$	%
Consultant Services		108,500	110,331	101.69
Training and Workshop		776,500	791,984	101.99
Goods/Services		531,000	516,563	97.28
Sub-Grants		1,220,000	1,214,511	99.55
Operating Costs		114,000	112,747	98.90
Total Expenditures		2,750,000	2,746,136	99.86



ANNEX 3. RECIPIENT, CO-FINANCIER AND OTHER PARTNER/STAKEHOLDER COMMENTS

The ICR was shared and discussed with the Client, however, the Bank team has not received written comments from the Client.

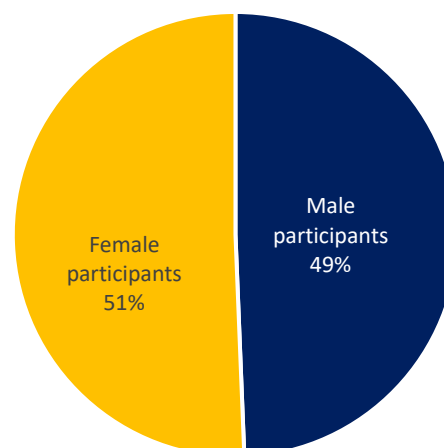


ANNEX 4. SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS (IF ANY)

A. BREAKDOWN OF BENEFICIARIES REACHED THROUGH LC SENSITIZATION INTERVENTIONS, BY GENDER

Participants in the LC sensitization interventions

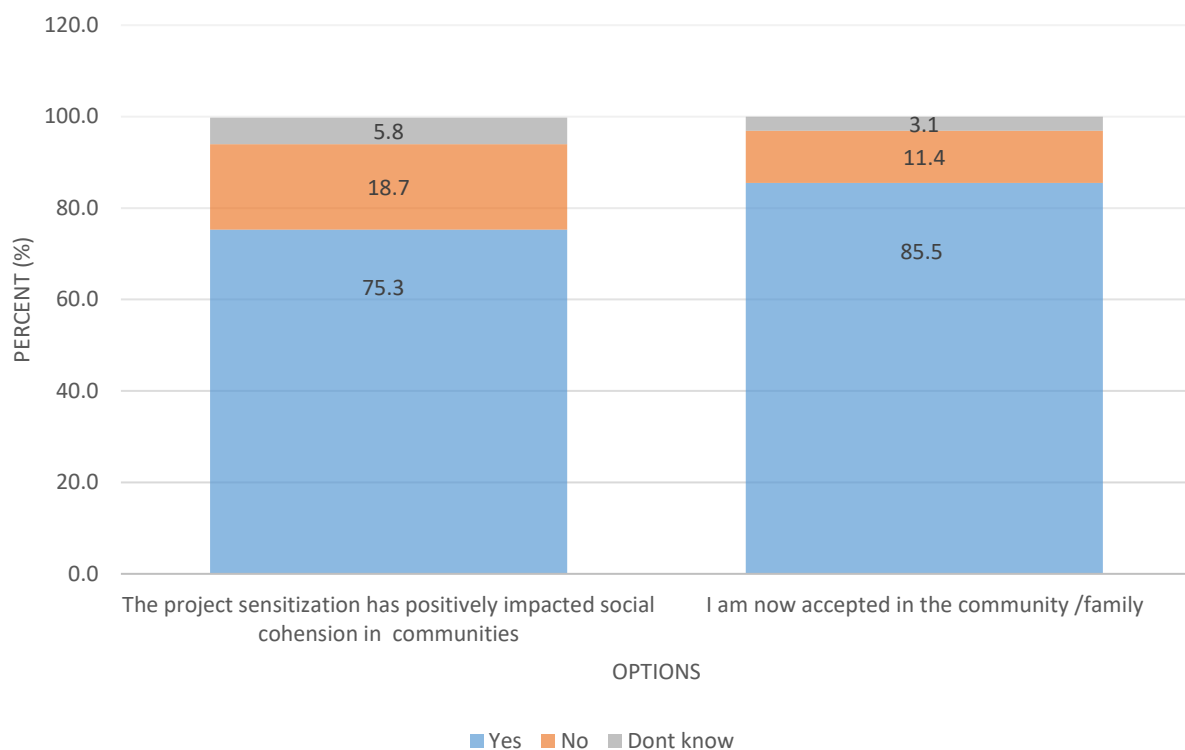
Year	Male participants	Female participants	% of female participants	Total no. of beneficiaries
2018	920	1,080	54%	2,000
2019	4,386	5,088	54%	9,474
2020	13,575	13,200	49%	26,775
Total	18,881	19,368	51%	38,249



Source: M&E specialist (the figures are from Data Collected during implementation of Project Activities)

B. IMPACT OF SENSITIZATION ACTIVITY

The positive impact of project sensitization on the social cohesion and community reintegration



Source: Final BA assessment (2020)



C. DESCRIPTION OF PARTICIPATORY BUDGETING PROCESS

1. Through the decentralization reform in 2005, LCs assumed responsibility for development planning. The Government of Sierra Leone rolled out the devolution process which involved the transfer of functions, power, authority and accompanying resources to the LCs. The LCs assumed major responsibilities in the areas of Education (delivering primary and junior secondary school education), Health and Sanitation (delivering primary and secondary health care), Solid Waste Management, and Rural Water and Social Assistance Services. Although the LCs had assumed responsibility for development planning, effective involvement of local communities/villages in problem identification, needs assessment and prioritization of Interventions to ensure that the LCs Development plans truly reflect the people's aspirations remained a key challenge. The local level planning process lacked the feedback loop to ensure that the local communities were fully informed about the selection process of the planned interventions prioritized at the LC.

2. Participatory Budgeting (PB) under sub-component 2B under the Project was therefore designed to address this challenge. This intervention was designed to increase deliberation processes within the communities, while guaranteeing effective participation of marginalized groups especially at the ward level. PB involves citizens in the decision-making processes of the LCs by allocating resources to their preferred public sector activities/projects. Through PB, service delivery is aligned with the priorities of the beneficiaries and the beneficiaries are instrumental in making the allocation of resources hence, making it more inclusive and equitable. In March 2019, PB was piloted in two of the most severely EVD affected LCs, ie. FCC and PortLoko District Council. The PB process ensured that citizens (especially at ward level) in both FCC and Port Loko District Councils selected their preferred projects to be part of the budget of the two pilot councils for 2020.

3. A PB sub-grant with a total value of US\$250,000 was allocated to each of the two LCs, with the selection of subprojects being determined by community participants according to a process that aims to empower citizens at ward and community levels to identify and develop their preferred projects. The overall mechanism of PB was as follows:

- The citizens were required to vote
- The projects with the highest number of votes were prioritized for implementation by the LCs with the involvement of the Ward Committees in the various localities.
- Disbursements toward completion of sub-projects were done by the LCs and included in their Annual Work Plan.
- Sub-projects were to be accepted for the purchase of goods for the community, the payment of services, and rehabilitation works that do not require land acquisition.
- A minimum participation threshold of 2,500 votes cast in each LC was needed for the deliberation process to be considered valid
- Due to COVID-19 and the restrictions the voting process targeted 100 participants from the wards. (A total of 1000 (50% female) people voted across all wards).

4. The PB was executed in several phases as outlined below:



- A public information campaign to promote PB in the district and wards⁴⁸
- Ward deliberation processes to discuss proposals
- Proposals were compared at the LC level and costs and options that were duplicated or not feasible eliminated
- Public meetings at the ward level and a grassroots communication campaign were organized in order to inform citizens about proposed projects
- Citizens voted for their preferred projects at the ward level
- Projects with the highest number of votes were implemented by the LCs
- Beneficiaries 9 PB wards (4 in Port Loko District Council (241, 247, 250, 252) and 5 in FCC (402, 403, 404, 408, and 410)

5. Due to the weak capacity in FM and procurement matters and lack of political will, PB faced implementation delays. The inclusion of FDD following the project restructuring in January 2020 accelerated implementation. Despite this delay, CMGs were set up, deliberation and voting took place, and 16 subprojects in both LCs have been implemented. However, PB was rated as ***Moderately Satisfactory*** in the last Aide Mémoire (November 30 – December 10, 2020) due to the delays encountered. The remaining of annex 4 (D to I) has information on PB implementation, including the type of projects implemented, the number of beneficiaries, type of sectors, and pictures showing projects before and after PB interventions.

6. In conclusion, PB introduced a community participatory safety nets approach to better reach and support EVD survivors and their families through improving their access to better service. By improving service delivery and bringing services closer to targeted communities, PB promoted opportunities to build human capital and assets to the poor while enhancing community resilience by empowering communities to have a voice and decide on their priorities.

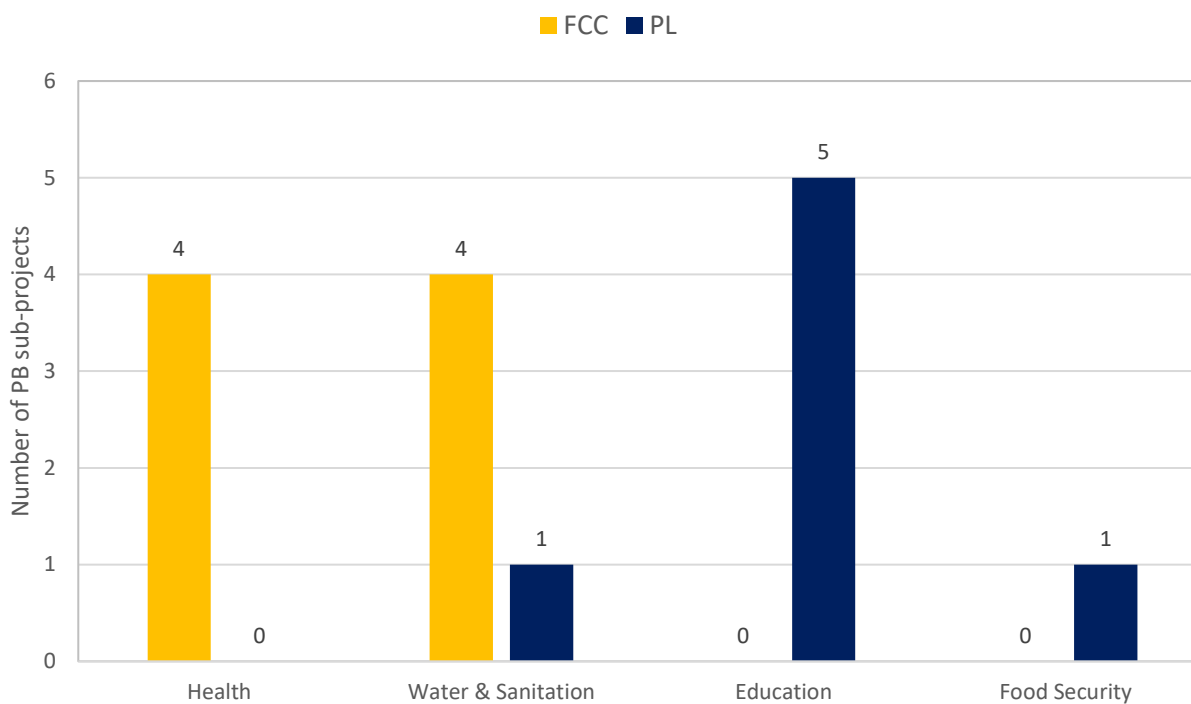
⁴⁸ Two Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) were recruited and contracted to mobilize and animate communities to participate in the PB process. These organizations are; (i) Sierra Leone Social-Aid Volunteers (for Port Loko District Council) and (ii) Health Alerts Sierra Leone (for FCC

). Working with the CSOs has increased cooperation and participation of the communities not only in the PB activities, but in the activities of the LCs generally. The CSOs are community based, have long standing relationship with the communities, knows the community and command the respect of the communities. The presence of the CSOs in this intervention has instilled confidence in the people. The people are turning out in their numbers and giving out their best with the aim to let the PB succeed.



D. PARTICIPATORY BUDGETING SUB-PROJECT SECTORS DISTRIBUTION

Distribution of PB sub-projects sectors in both LCs



- *PL refers to Port Loko.*
- *Food security project in PL was the rehabilitation of rice grain store*
- *The data for this graph obtained from the PB technical status reports. One project in FCC was not reflected in this graph because it supported the fabrication and erection of signposts*



E. JSDF PARTICIPATORY BUDGETING SUB PROJECTS IN PORT LOKO

SCOPE OF WORK	SITE LOCATION	SECTOR	ACHIEVED WORKED	DIRECT BENEFICIARIES (Pupils)	No. OF INDIRECT BENEFICIARIES	UNIT COST (Sierra Leonean)	COST OF JSDF SUB-PROJECTS (Sierra Leonean)
• Rehabilitation of Five Classroom block • Rehabilitation of School toilet • Rehabilitation of borehole water well • Rehabilitation of 2x3 Compartment School toilets	Lot 2 - Ward 247 Bundulia, Kamasondo Chiefdom	Education	• Completed Roofing for the school and toilet • Doors & windows installed • Screed of classroom finished • Hard board ceiling finished and electrical installation completed too • Plastering finishing of the columns, beams, windows and doors completed • Apron also has been constructed round the perimeter of the school • Ramp has been completed • Windows glazing completed • Concreting the drainages walls and floor round the perimeter of the school • Painting of the school and toilet • Rehabilitation of hand pump well	Boys= 265 Girls = 203 ----- Total= 468	14,228	352,625,640	318,140,900
Rehabilitation of St. Joseph's RC Primary School, including the rehabilitation of 2x3 compartment school toilet, the rehabilitation of hand pump well, and the rehabilitation of School toilet.	Lot 3 - Ward 250 Kagbantama Kasseh Chiefdom	Education	• Completed roofing of the school • Ceiling completed • Completed installing windows & doors • Floor screed finished for the classroom & corridor • Drainage work also completed. • Existing structural ramp has been structurally reinforced for pupils with disability. • Rehabilitation of school toilet finished. • Priming of classroom walls, columns, and beams. • Windows glazing completed • Painting of the school and toilet • Rehabilitation of hand pump well	Boys= 258 Girls = 259 ----- Total= 517	14,511	310,220,000	293,473,105



SCOPE OF WORK	SITE LOCATION	SECTOR	ACHIEVED WORKED	DIRECT BENEFICIARIES (Pupils)	No. OF INDIRECT BENEFICIARIES	UNIT COST (Sierra Leonean)	COST OF JSDF SUB-PROJECTS (Sierra Leonean)
Rehabilitation of Saint Peters School, including the rehabilitation of School toilet	Lot 3 - Ward 250 Romehni, Kasseh Chiefdom	Education	• Completed Roofing for the school and toilet • Doors & windows installed • Screed of classroom finished • Hard board ceiling finished and electrical installation completed too. • Plastering finishing of the columns, beams, windows and doors completed. • Apron also has been constructed round the perimeter of the school. • Ramp has been completed • Rehabilitation of School toilet. • Installation of windows glazing • Painting of the school and toile	Boys= 164 Girls = 176 ----- Total= 340	14,511	150,600,000	100,720,000
Rehabilitation of 6 Classroom at SLMB Primary School, Gbaneh Bana, including the rehabilitation of 2x3 Compartment VIP Latrine at SLMB Primary School, Gbaneh Bana and the rehabilitation of Hand Pump Well at SLMB Primary School, Gbaneh Bana	Lot 1 - Ward 241 Gbaneh Bana, Lokomasama Chiefdom	Education	• Roofing of the SLMB school completed • Apron and drainages also constructed • Installation of classroom windows & doors frame finished • Hardboard Ceiling Completed • Screed of classroom floors completed • Plastering finishing of the windows and doors edges completed • Glazing of windows completed • Ramp also constructed • Glazing of windows • Priming of the school • Painting of the school	Boys= 210 Girls = 241 ----- Total= 451	20,314	368,245,000	252,172,100



SCOPE OF WORK	SITE LOCATION	SECTOR	ACHIEVED WORKED	DIRECT BENEFICIARIES (Pupils)	No. OF INDIRECT BENEFICIARIES	UNIT COST (Sierra Leonean)	COST OF JSDF SUB-PROJECTS (Sierra Leonean)
Rehabilitation of Marcus Garvey JSS (3 Classroom Block) Gbaneh Bana	Lot 1 - Ward 241 Gbaneh Bana, Lokomasama Chiefdom	Education	• Roofing of the Marcus Garvey JSS 3 school completed • Apron and drainages also constructed • Installation of classroom windows & doors frame finished • Hardboard Ceiling Completed • Screed of classroom floors completed • Plastering finishing of the windows and doors edges completed • Ramp also constructed • Electrical installation • Apron and drainages	Boys= 140 Girls = 200 ----- Total= 340	20,314	222,145,000	116,017,000
Rehabilitation of rice grain store and the rehabilitation of drying floor	Lot 4 - Ward 252 Komrabai, Marampa Chiefdom	Food Security	• Sub-Structure/Foundation completed • Plinth level/oversight completed • Roof profile completed • Windows and doors installed • Installation of roofing sheet • Foundation of dry floor • Electrical installation • Oversight of drying floor • Painting of the rice grain store • Installation of hard board ceiling		17,498	360,913,900	236,453,900
Rehabilitation of 4 compartment VIP toilet and the rehabilitation of Tube/hand pump well	Lot 4 - Ward 252 Komrabai, Marampa Chiefdom	Sanitation	• Sub-structure completed for the toilet pit depth of 3m, • installation of pit breathing pipe, and • Concreting the well casing. • Painting and tiling of the 4 compartment VIP toilet bathroom completed • Rehabilitation of hand pump well		17,498	175,625,500	146,018,500



F. JSDF PARTICIPATORY BUDGETING SUB PROJECTS IN FCC

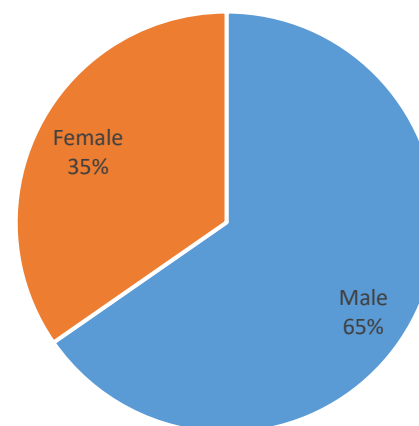
SCOPE OF WORK	SITE LOCATION	SECTOR	ACHIEVED WORKED	NO. OF DIRECT AND INDIRECT BENEFICIARIES	UNIT COST (Sierra Leonean)	COST OF JSDF SUB-PROJECTS (Sierra Leonean)
* Completion of Cemetery Perimeter fence and Rehabilitation of Security Post * Construction of Cemetery Toilet	Ward 402, Robis	Health & Sanitation	* Perimeter fence completed * Roofing of Security post completed	38,000	650,000,000	452,799,000
Construction of MCHP	Ward 403, Bottom Oku	Primary Health Care	Roofing and plastering (inside and outside) completed	15,600	620,000,000	490,932,000
Completion of CHC	Ward 404, Calabatown	Primary Health Care	Fitting of electrical cables completed. Plumbing completed. Painting of windows and doors completed. Tiling of main offices, toilets and reception completed	25,000	500,000,000	450,325,000
Construction of CHC	Ward 408, Rokupa Wharf	Primary Health Care	Roofing complete. Installation of conduit pipes complete. Plastering of inside and outside complete. Fixing of internal and external doors completed. Biofill toilet constructed	15,000	650,000,000	450,028,000
* Construction of 150m Drainage * Construction of Culverts * Drilling of Borehole	Ward 410, Kuntolloh	Water & Sanitation	* 150m Storm Drain completed * Construction of 1.5m box culvert completed * Completion of the drilling of bore hole well pipe at a depth of 155m.	20,000	450,000,000	454,139,000
Administrative Cost including. Fabrication and erection of signposts			Fabrication and erection of 6 signposts. Stationery. Payment for EIA Report. Redress Mechanism Boxes X5. Monitoring and Supervision. Launching of the Projects			201,777,000



G. NUMBER OF PEOPLE EMPLOYED IN THE FREETOWN AND PORT LOKO PARTICIPATORY BUDGETING SUB-PROJECT

Number of beneficiaries employed in the PB sub-project by LC (left table) and disaggregated by gender (right pie chat)

No.	District	Ward	Male	Female	Total employed
1	FCC	402	14	6	20
2	FCC	403	20	10	30
3	FCC	404	20	8	28
4	FCC	408	22	10	32
5	FCC	410	19	6	25
6	Port Loko	252	18	12	30
7	Port Loko	241	12	8	20
8	Port Loko	241	7	5	12
9	Port Loko	247	8	10	18
10	Port Loko	250	12	6	18
11	Port Loko	250	12	6	18
			164	87	251



Source: DecSec team



H. PHOTOS OF PB (COMMUNICATION CAMPAIGN, CITIZEN VOTING AND SUB-PROJECTS IN FCC)

PB communication materials





Citizens vote for their preferred projects at the ward level





Completion of Robis Cemetery Perimeter fence (FCC)





Construction of Bottom Oku MCHP (FCC)





Construction of 150m storm drain (FCC)





Construction of 2x3 Compartment VIP Latrines at SLMB Primary (Port Loko)





Rehabilitation of Hand Pump Well at DEC Primary School, Bundulia (Port Loko)



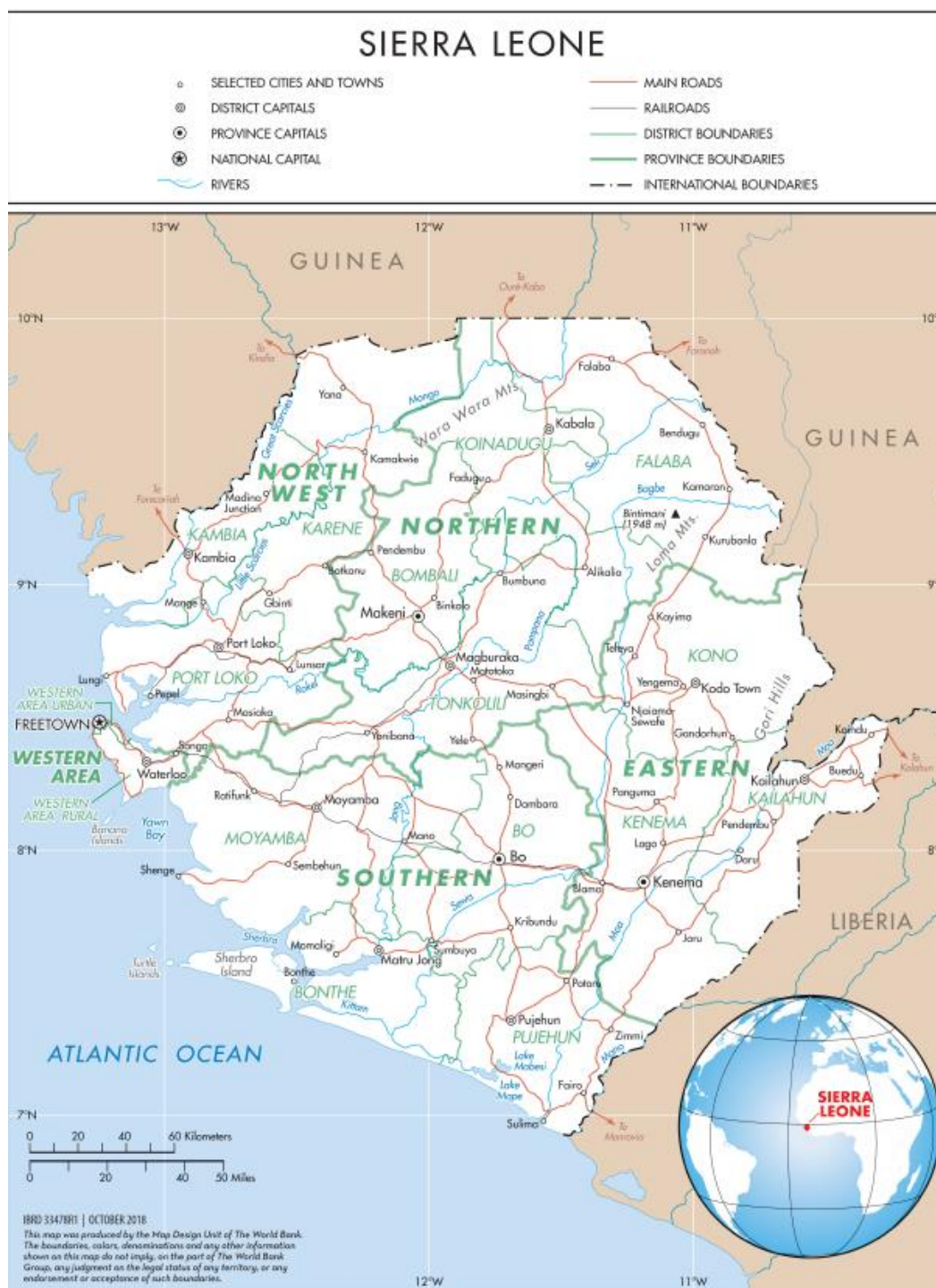


Ward 247 Rehabilitation of DEC Primary School, Bundulia (Port Loko)





I. MAP OF SIERRA LEONE (CLEARED BY THE BANK'S CARTOGRAPHY UNIT, APRIL 2020)





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